



FH Salzburg

Master Degree Program "Innovation and Management in Tourism"

University of Applied Sciences Salzburg

BRANDED MOVING PICTURES

BRAND COMMUNICATION OF DESTINATION BRANDS

WITH MOVING PICTURES

MASTER THESIS SUBMITTED TO THE UOAS SALZBURG
IN PARTIAL FULFILMENT OF THE REQUIREMENTS FOR THE DEGREE OF
"MASTER OF ARTS IN BUSINESS"

Author:	Viktoria Münch, BA
Student number:	1710649007
Date:	15/07/2019
Supervisor:	FH-Prof Mag. (FH) Mag. Dr. Mario Jooss BAKK.

Acknowledgments

I would like to express my deep gratitude to my family, especially to my deceased godfather.
For supporting me and for making this all possible.

Furthermore, I am particularly grateful for the assistance given by my supervisor Dr. Mario Jooss.

I would also like to extend my thanks to all experts for sharing insights of their expertise:

Lukas Dallinger, Klaus Ehrenbrandtner, Jonathan Forsthuber, Till Fuhrmeister,
Miriam Geiregger, Manuel Kuhn, Florian Pollstätter, Sandra Thier

Finally, I truly want to thank my private surrounding for their constant support and for the good
advices that never let me lose my motivation.

I.	TABLE OF CONTENTS	
II.	LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS	IV
III.	LIST OF ILLUSTRATIONS	V
IV	LIST OF TABLES	VI
V.	ABSTRACT	VII
1	INTRODUCTION	8
2	ROLE OF PICTURES IN MEDIA HISTORY	10
2.1	INTRODUCING TERMS	10
2.2	THE IMAGE WAS FIRST	11
2.3	TECHNIC-BASED PICTURES: PHOTOGRAPHY AND FILM	13
2.4	DIGITAL PICTURES – THE BEGINNING OF THE MULTIMEDIA ERA	15
2.5	MOVING PICTURES - A MEAN TO CATCH THE ATTENTION	16
2.6	MASS MEDIA, THE PUBLIC GENERAL AND THE PLANNING OF AN AGENDA	17
2.7	CONCLUSION	18
3	THE RELATION OF PICTURES AND NEUROLOGY	20
3.1	THE NEUROLOGICAL EFFECT OF PICTURES	20
3.2	NEUROMARKETING – WAYS TO AROUSE THE BRAIN	21
3.3	HOW ADVERTISEMENTS EXERT AND HOW BRANDS FIGHT FOR ATTENTION	23
3.4	CONCLUSION	24
4	MODERN MARKETING COMMUNICATIONS AND THE BRANDING OF DESTINATIONS	25
4.1	DESTINATION BRANDING	25
4.2	NATION BRANDING	26
4.3	BRAND CODE MANAGEMENT	27
4.4	MODERN MARKETING COMMUNICATIONS	28
4.5	EFFECTS ON BRAND COMMUNICATION IN TOURISM	29
4.6	MOVING PICTURES IN BRAND COMMUNICATIONS	30
4.7	MOVING PICTURES AND SOCIAL MEDIA	32
4.8	MOVING PICTURES IN TOURISM	33
4.9	CONCLUSION	34
5	CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK	36
6	RESEARCH METHODOLOGY	38
6.1	EXPERT INTERVIEWS	38
6.2	RESEARCH DESIGN	38
6.3	EXPERT SAMPLE AND PROFILE	39
6.4	INTERVIEW GUIDE	40
6.5	DATA ANALYSIS	41
7	RESULTS AND DISCUSSION	42
7.1	APPLICATION IN BRAND COMMUNICATION	42
7.2	KEY CHARACTERISTICS	44
7.3	INTEGRATION IN TOURISM	48
7.4	FUTURE ASSESSMENT	51
8	CONCLUSION	53
8.1	PRACTICAL IMPLICATIONS	54
8.2	THEORETICAL IMPLICATIONS	54
8.3	LIMITATIONS AND FUTURE RESEARCH	54
VI	REFERENCES	VIII
VII	APPENDIX	XV

II. List of abbreviations

DMO.....	Destination Marketing/Management Organization
E.....	Expert
ICT.....	Information & Communication Technology
IMC.....	Integrated Marketing Communication
UGC.....	User-generated Content
USP.....	Unique Selling Proposition
VR.....	Virtual Reality

III. List of illustrations

Figure 1 Theoretical pillars; Source: Author	9
Figure 2 Communication model; Source: Friedemann Schulz von Thun, 1981	10
Figure 3 Summary of media historical developments, Source: Author, based on Böhn & Seidler, 2014	11
Figure 4 Kinds of photography vs. film; Source: Author, based on Böhn & Seidler, 2014	14
Figure 5 Limbic® map Consult AG; Source: Author, by Gruppe Nymphenburg	22
Figure 6 Reasons why to brand a destination Source: Author	25
Figure 7 Basis of brand communication; Source: Author	28
Figure 8 Driving forces for increased moving picture consumption; Source: Author.....	31
Figure 9 Benefits of using moving pictures; Source: Author	32
Figure 10 Conceptual framework; Source: Author	36
Figure 11 Research process; Source: Author	39
Figure 12 Categories for qualitative content analysis, Source: Author.....	41
Figure 13 Application in brand communication; Source: Author	42
Figure 14 Key characteristics of moving pictures, Source: Author.....	44
Figure 15 Integration in tourism, Source: Author.....	48
Figure 16 Application of communication model after Schulz von Thun; Source: Author.....	49
Figure 17 Future assessment; Source: Author.....	51

IV. List of tables

Table 1 Interview details; Source: Author	39
Table 2 Expert sample; Source: Author.....	40
Table 3 Example of qualitative content analysis based on P. Mayring; Source: Author.....	41

V. Abstract

This thesis examines the key characteristics of moving pictures as part of the brand communication mix and its integration in tourism. It furthermore elaborates on future assessments by conducting explorative and qualitative research with altogether eight experts. In order to conduct the research, theoretical concepts affecting the application of moving pictures are reviewed. Literature regarding media historical developments, concerning neuromarketing insights and in regard to modern marketing communications serves the establishment of a conceptual framework and has been adapted to develop a semi-structured interview guide. The results suggest practical as well as theoretical implications. Moving pictures are claimed to be more powerful than any other media and are characterized by the ability to emotionalize with the recipient. In addition, moving pictures enable to reach all target groups, independent from segmentation characteristics. Furthermore, the conducted research has proven the need to engage with the target audience to the same extent as with the brand and to gain insights into the values of both perspectives that is paramount for the creation of moving pictures. By applying these insights, moving pictures contribute to the virtual experience of tourists, especially in the pre-travel and inspiration phase. Thus, branded moving pictures count as enrichment for both, the sender of the message as well as for the receiver. In regard to future assessments, experts do expect moving pictures to be increasingly implemented in the field of brand communication due to the increase of acknowledgment and technological enhancements.

Keywords: brand communication; moving pictures; modern marketing communication; tourism; virtual experience

1 Introduction

It is a fact, that the emersion of the Internet and its constant further developments, the environment of marketing and marketing communication has altered (Dev et al., 2010). For brands, this means, that there is nowadays no way around moving pictures as an integrated part of the communication mix. Brand communication with moving pictures benefits from both, the advantages of classic TV advertisement and those of online advertising. The ability to emotionalize with the recipient by addressing multisensorial is assigned whilst the opportunities of an explicit targeting and the measurement of the performance are given. At the same time, users or recipients are able to interact with each other (Herold & Schulze, 2019).

Meanwhile, and this highlights the great importance of social media being integrated on all marketing activities of tourism destinations, such social platforms empowers the consumer and tourist to co-create (Benckendorff, Sheldon, & Fesenmaier, 2014; Fisk, 2015; Neuhofer & Buhalis, 2013) and become an active consumer (Mielau & Schmiegelow, 2019).

Moreover, the tourism and travel industry is constantly influenced by the developments of information and communication technologies. It furthermore intends to benefit from the synergies between technology and tourism (Neuhofer, Buhalis, & Ladkin, 2012). In general, online and on-screen content counts as the main source of information for travellers and tourists and the main driver for inspiration (Marchiori & Cantoni, 2011). Nevertheless, the impacts of visual content generally have proven to be beneficial for the tourism industry, though the realm of moving pictures seems to be disregarded so far, especially from the sender perspective. This might explain the fact that existing literature seems to not elaborate on the key aspects and characteristics of moving pictures.

Hence, the aim of this thesis is to explore expertise in the field on brand communication and to apply the findings in the tourism context. Consequently, the method of qualitative and explorative expert interviews is chosen to answer following research question and sub-questions:

RQ 1. What are the key characteristics of moving pictures in brand communication?

SQ 1. How could these key characteristics be integrated into the brand communication of destination brands?

SQ 2. How do brand communication practitioners assess the future of moving pictures in brand communication?

Finally, findings propose to give insights for brand communication practitioners on how to strategically apply moving pictures in the communication mix, especially in the tourism context. This thesis addresses practitioners from the industry as well as scholars and focuses on a specific business subject which is brand communication and the strategic implementation of

moving pictures. Thus, the worldview of constructivism is adapted as the philosophical paradigm of this thesis. Creswell (2014) explains this perspective with the aim of understanding the world in which individuals develop subjective views and opinions. Hence, this thesis elaborates on the different views regarding moving pictures which posed to be the basis of this constructivist research.

Therefore, there are three main realms to be explained within this thesis that justify why to choose moving pictures as the main research subject. Figure 1 summarizes those three dimensions that are first, media history as the usage of moving pictures seems to be a consequence of historical developments in communication. Second, neurological insights that pushed the integration of moving pictures for strategic brand communication purposes and finally, modern marketing communication that bases on those insights of history and neurological sciences and implements those findings in the concept of brand communication. In addition, those realms do structure the literature review of this thesis.

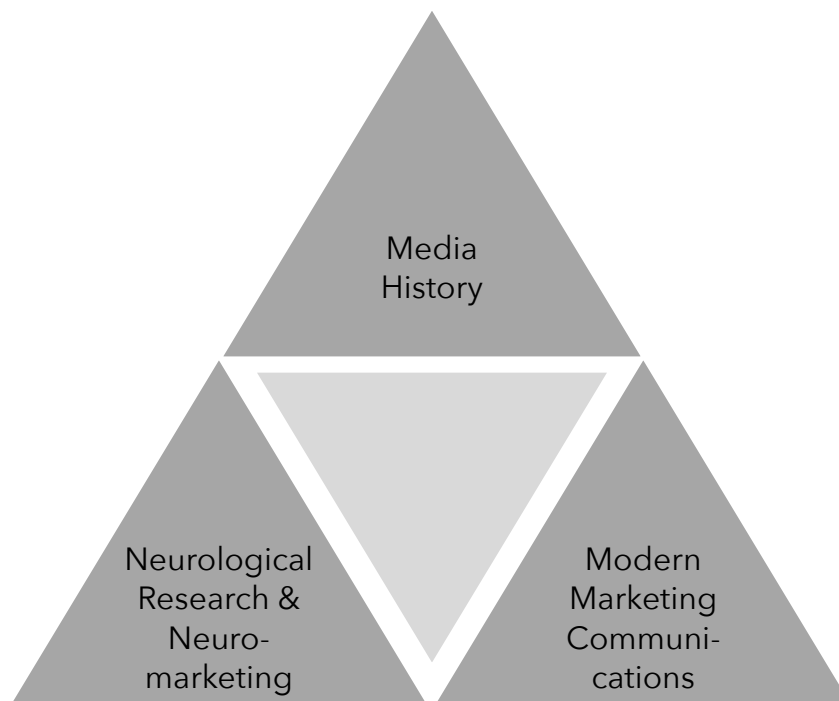


Figure 1 Theoretical pillars; Source: Author

2 Role of pictures in media history

At the beginning of this chapter, the main concepts that are essential for the common understanding of this academic work are explained. Followed by historical insights concerning pictures. It emphasises how pictures have developed over time and have challenged the media offer in general. The chapter continues with a closer focus on photography and film as it is necessary to understand the basis of those two concepts. Furthermore, and as history shows, the multimedia era is influencing the media consumption significantly and is thus discussed afterwards.

2.1 Introducing terms

For the purpose of a common understanding, some terms are clarified in the first step. What the concept of media and the active sides of a message refer to give the basis of this master thesis.

Media in general, enables one to convey a meaning, a message or a representation of something (Böhn & Seidler, 2014; Doelker, 1997). The word itself derived from the Latin word medium that connects the sender and the recipient to transmit information. Media are means that cause perceptions such as noise or smells, that serve us to communicate as words and language and that enable distribution regarding the time and location such as the Internet or social platforms (Tropp, 2011). In this thesis though, the term media refers to the distribution function in order to convey a message.

Moving pictures or moving images refer to multimedia content, combining audio-visual elements. It describes motion pictures and counts as a hypernym for film or video (Doelker, 1997).

Furthermore, within this study, the terms sender and receiver will emphasise the two sides of the four-side communication model by Schulz von Thun. Those terms indicate the sending media that addresses a message and the recipient that is addressed by the message as seen in figure 2 (Schulz von Thun, 1981).

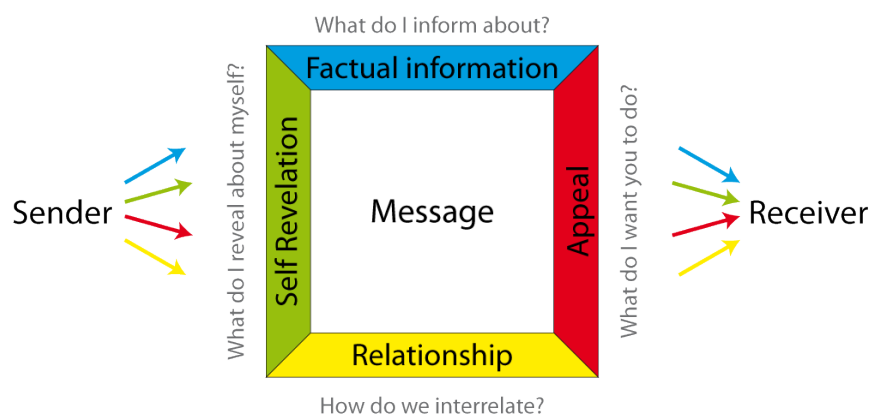


Figure 2 Communication model; Source: Friedemann Schulz von Thun, 1981

2.2 The image was first

Over the past 20000 years, communication with image media has significantly changed. The relation between language and pictures is the determining basis of these developments. At first human-made and posterior reproduced as digital mass media. Pictures have been the main media of communication for centuries. Only with the invention of the letterpress by Johannes Gutenberg in the 15th century (Kästner, 1978), pictures were detached by letters. Centuries later, the invention of photography added an essential shift in the history of media and the communication that so far mainly based on written letters (Böhn & Seidler, 2014). A historical overview aims to highlight the transformation of communication regarding pictures. Figure 3 supports the underlines historical discourse in the media history of pictures. #

Communication solely based on pictures can be traced back to 30 000 B.C when humans used cave painting to communicate (Stankowski, 1994) and to convey the representation of realistic, omnipresent objects such as animals as these paintings are unambiguously understood. Scientists assume that these cave paintings further involved symbolic meanings such as the right way to successful hunting. Hence it is to assume that communication-based on pictures aimed to not only convey the representation of reality but a meaningful message (Böhn & Seidler, 2014). In ancient times, however, the aim of using pictures was a detailed and a representation of known reality, mainly of humans. This is proven by an anecdote by Pliny the Elder, a Roman naturalist and philosopher, that tells about two painters that competed to be the one that can paint in a more realistic and hence detailed way than the other one. Thus, it is to assume that roughly 13 000 years later in history, the expression with pictures was rather to represent reality than to express a meaning or a message (Stocchetti & Kukkonen, 2011).

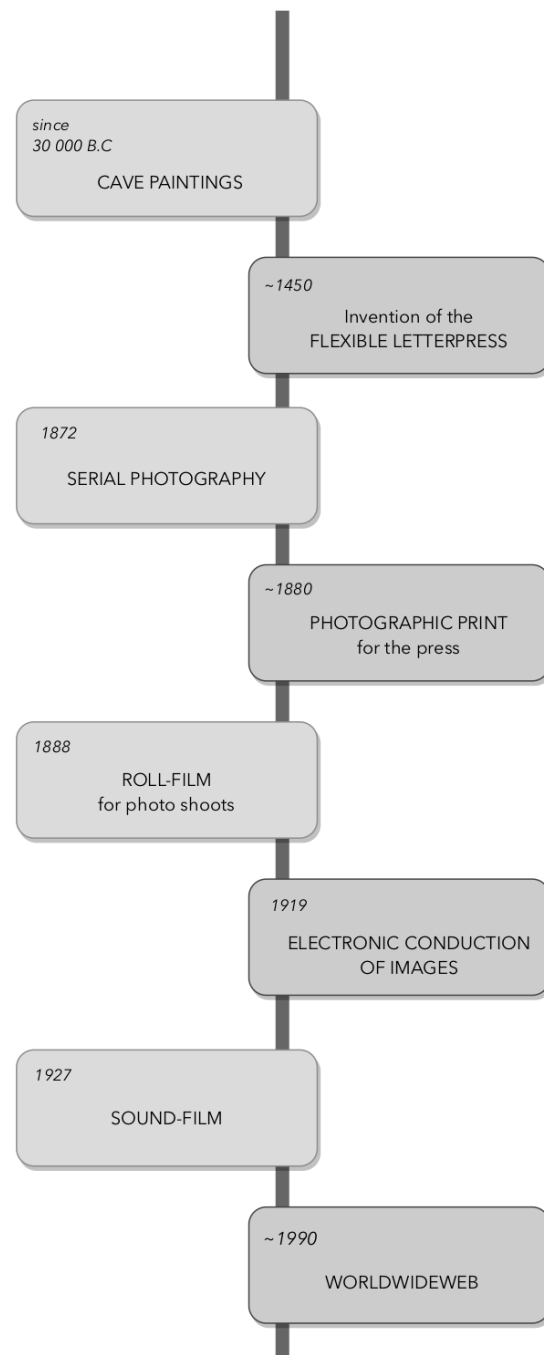


Figure 3 Summary of media historical developments,
Source: Author, based on Böhn & Seidler, 2014

Later in history, the symbolic meaning of pictures in terms of art and moreover, visual expression of meanings became significant. In the Middle Ages, the expression of religious imaginations determined the understanding of pictures (Belting, 2011). Even more, pictures that intended to represent the simple, mortal and transient reality were frowned upon and even forbidden. Art in this epoch solely conducted to illustrate religious meanings. However, to understand the conveyed message it was crucial to understanding the guiding background information based on the bible. Consequential, only the literate part of society that was able to read the bible, fully understood the religious meaning (Böhn & Seidler, 2014).

The ability to read in order to fully understand the pictures reinforced in the Renaissance when philosophy and nature posed to be the orientation of thinking and expressing. Especially nature was the foreground in terms of expressions. However, without knowing about the thoughts and perceptions of philosophers and scientists were, the full understanding of pictures was simply not possible (Fahlenbrach, 2019). Böhn and Seidler (2014) describe this phenomenon of text-based knowledge as the key to read the symbolic meaning of an original iconic representation. This means that though the picture is clearly recognisable, the true meaning that is represented is only to be understood with additional information. This information, in most cases, based on texts.

For the sake of not being forced to know the written messages behind the pictures in order to interpret them, textual elements – so-called *subscriptio* - were included. In the emblematic of the Baroque epoch, art media was thus accompanied by textual headings and a signature. A famous example is the emblem of Alciatus of 1542. Without those textual elements, observers of the pictures might have solely understood the iconic whilst the whole emblem enables the observer to clearly comprehend the message. Nowadays this principle can be still observed in the case of advertisement posters as they tend to represent iconic as well as textual elements (Böhn & Seidler, 2014).

With the invention of the flexible letterpress by Johannes Gutenberg around 1440 society has experienced the so-called reading revolution (Wittmann, 1982) which endured several centuries up until the industrial revolution in the 18th century. Though books were still limited in terms of reaction to the news, society was endeavours of having a media that was able to react immediately and to be spread simultaneously. Thus, newspapers became mainstream and with its periodical and newsworthy publication, they became the first mass media product. However, with the invention of the letterpress society - and not only privilege and thus literate people - was suddenly able to consume media simultaneously, no matter the distance. As a result, society in general and specifically in Europe became more literate which created a general public. The general public though swiftly became politically aware (Poe, 2011) which led to the one and other political revolution (McLuhan, 1962).

Contemporary, the term *belles lettres* was born (Böhn & Seidler, 2014). With the increased literate society, news media were consumed and created also for the sake of entertainment instead of an only informational purpose (Poe, 2011). Different text types and genres that developed during this era still exist according to Böhn and Seidler (2014). Simultaneously in

history, three main concepts in art resulted in the same aim of representing the reality: realism, classicism and mannerism. First intended to demonstrate the iconic representation of the reality whilst in classicism art showed the reality in a more beautiful and better way. The latter concept exhibited a more exaggerated way of reality such as Parmigianino's Madonna with the long neck (Madonna dal collo lungo, 1534-1540).

Media in general, either image- or text-based, continuously developed and so did art and literature in specific. The entertaining factor became predominantly when consuming media which resulted in several streams that still exist nowadays (Böhn & Seidler, 2014).

However, all forms of media until this point of media history were solely human-made and either textual- or visual-based. Due to the fact that this thesis aims to elaborate on technic-based, moving image content as a mean in communication, understanding the further development of media in terms of visuals and audio-visuals is of great importance.

2.3 Technic-based pictures: Photography and Film

Photographs count as the first technic-based media. All visual media productions prior relied on human's interaction. It recorded what could be visually perceived which means that photography aimed to represent what could be seen in a realistic way, not subjectively imagined as in contrast with paintings (Fahlenbrach, 2019). Scholars highlight the fact that photography increased the cognitive perceptiveness due to the ability to observe the photographs again and again after the photocopied moment occurred. What has been only possible for experts became mass media in the 1880s when the first roll film and the photographic print were invented. Before that, only well-trained photographers were able to operate those heavy, highly-sensitive and complex cameras. The easier it got to implement visual media the more it was seized by publishers (Silverman, 2015).

Similar to the historical development that art faced, photography likewise intended to represent the actual visual perception (Reutner & Lentos Kunstmuseum Linz, 2008; Mullen, 1998) but was later one used to beautify the reality. One who knew the exact technical procedure could seize it to change the settings in order to visually optimize the subject. The latter phenomenon is referred to as the term of art photography while documentary photography indicates the capture of an actual subject or happening. Art photography was not a portrayal of reality anymore, rather it became questionable in the sense of honesty and true communication of a technical captured perception (Böhn & Seidler, 2014; Mullen, 1998).

Manipulation and falsification were since that point questioned in terms of visual media (Doelker, 1997), especially when digitalisation revolutionized photography. As photographs were no longer analogue but digital and saved on a storage media, manipulation or falsifications can no longer be proven. And suddenly visual media could represent a reality that was in fact not real. Moreover, whether if the photograph is analogously or digitally taken is barely noticeable (Böhn & Seidler, 2014). What started as an experiment turned out to be the

invention of film. Scientists attempted to examine motion sequences of animals by taking photographs serially. The concept of serial photography was first mentioned in the 1870s and poses to be the foundation of the film and moving image media. This kind of media can be explained as a hybrid of photography as it is the advancement and a serial product of single shots, of art as the image composition is the determining principle in terms of shooting and lastly of theatre, as film media substantially and formally based on narratives. Either fictionally in terms of narrative content for the entertaining purpose or with the full intention to depict what is actually seen. Portraying emotions posed to be one of the main goals of filmmakers (Böhn & Seidler, 2014; Monaco, 2000). Figure 4 indicates the kinds to differentiate in terms of photography and film.

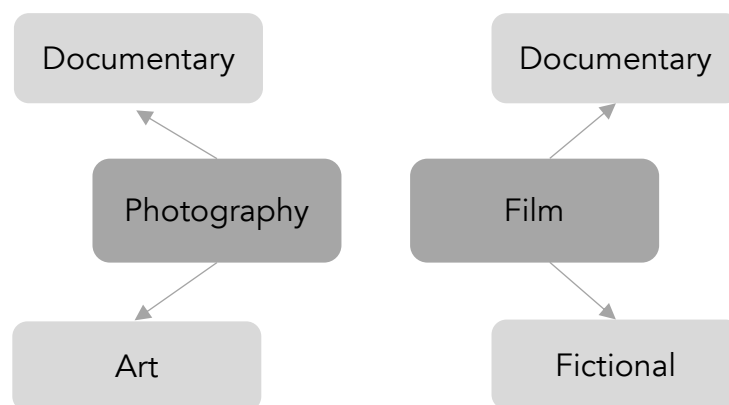


Figure 4 Kinds of photography vs. film; Source: Author, based on Böhn & Seidler, 2014

The reason for this is the universal comprehensibility of emotions (Ekman, 1970). They are connected with aesthetics and with a contextual background and hence an accurate mean to convey adequately feelings. In the end, it is about conveying emotions as content that combined relevance and triggers emotions is characterised by a stable memory (Doelker, 1997). Using close-ups, for instance, aims to highlight facial expressions and thus guides the viewer to focus on single aspects which then create emotions (Böhn & Seidler, 2014).

The pursuit of representing the reality, of telling stories, of causing emotions and showing actions that are comprehensible and plausible for the audience resulted in more effort to represent an even more detailed simulation. This led to further enhancement of the technical creation. Therefore, originally black and white moving image tapes were coloured afterwards. Night scenes, for example, were not possible to be shot. Colouring the tape afterwards, which's technique is called *tinting*, enabled to increase the realistic effect. In the case of such night scenes, for instance, the colour blue was used to highlight the nightly shooting time. Only since the 1950's the real *technicolour* – coloured shot sequences – were available (Böhn & Seidler, 2014).

However, then and still today, the industry is driven more by fictional films than by documentary films as the entertaining and escaping factor is determining (Monaco, 2000). The viewer is

supposed to consume film media without noticing that it is a purposely created mean to convey stories (Böhn & Seidler, 2014). The aim is to “trick” the audience to maintain a continuous and clear narrative by applying a technique of *continuity editing* (Bordwell, 1985; Bordwell & Thomson, 2010; Cutting, 2005). Even advertising spots that were already part of a cinema show back at the beginning of film history were created with fictional plots in order to delight the audience. With the demand for fictional storytelling and continuous technical development, the industry then differentiated between live-action and animated films (Böhn & Seidler, 2014). Latter is a fully artificially created product and does not shoot any real object. Though, even when fully automated, the main function of such films is to represent a realistic scenario. In other words, even when the medial product is obviously fully automated, the plot intends to narrate a story that seems comprehensible and thus realistic for the viewer's (Engell, 1992).

At the beginning of the 20th century the radio, the second periodical media and auditive only media were implemented to society. Besides the newspaper, its use was to periodically inform society (Fahlenbrach, 2019). What was first only available for the upper class due to its high costs became mass media during the second world war. In order to popularise, the agenda included not only informational news but music and other entertaining features. At the same time, radio gadgets became affordable and its main use then was to spread propaganda (Lersch & Schanze, 2004). After the war, its main periodical informational use altered as TV became part of societies' living rooms. Auditive content was suddenly mainly consumed en passant while television was turned on at times to which radio content was originally consumed. This not only changed the consumer behaviour but the agenda to shorter reports and shows. Remarkably and repeatedly in media history is the development towards pictures, more precisely towards audio-visual moving image content. Whilst the entertaining aspect as the main criterion to watch TV still endured, the possibility to escape reality was increasingly demanded. Böhn and Seiler describe the human desire to overcome time and space and to immerse as another main factor of moving image media consumption besides the entertainment. Thus the mindset of society identified obtaining a TV with the magical ability to actually escape (Böhn & Seidler, 2014).

2.4 Digital pictures – The beginning of the multimedia era

As stated in the previous chapter, the usage of media, no matter what kind, was originally only for the privileged, literate and wealthy people of society due to high costs and the expertise that was acquired.

Photography became mainstream once further developed and hence simplified – either concerning its access or in its usage (Peres, Osterman, Romer, Stuart, & Lopez, 2008). A similar development characterised the computer. The beginnings of computer root back in times of punch card machines in 1822. Around a hundred years later, a German and a British engineer invented independently from each other the first computer, both for military purposes (Zimmermann, 2017). While Konrad Zuse came up with the programme-controlled computer, Alan Turing invented the first computer that was able to automatically calculate. The initial

purpose was to save, process and automatize textual data. Only with the need to illustrate data graphically, advancements towards a user-friendly gadget were aimed.

The transition from text-based to image-based displays supported the universal media development of computers which led to the same development as before with the ability to read and the handling of a camera. The term mass media in the case of computers is substituted by universal media due to the fact that data from several media can be saved and processed. This enables the conjunction of multimedia in one gadget. In terms of digitalisation, the term multimedia refers to all digital data in one electronic device: a computer, tablet or similar. For the first time, single elements as texts, audios, pictures and moving pictures can be interlinked, exchanged and individually structured. However, the flexibility to structure single elements facilitated digital technological settings. In respect to film and moving image media, one can edit data aiming to change and even to manipulate in the sense of a biased representation (Böhn & Seidler, 2014).

However, Böhn and Seidler highlight that digital data of any kind needs a screen to be presented. In the sense of TV, the purpose in most cases is to periodically show content, adapted to watching times and consumer's behaviour. Regarding digital online media in the Worldwide Web, such content is characterized by durability.

2.5 Moving pictures - A mean to catch the attention

The communication scientist Doelker describes moving pictures as a term that refers to a maximum of four elements. Image texts, picture sequences, spoken words and audios. Resolutely, moving pictures are the sum of more elements beyond a single image. In his publication of 1997, he claims to omit redundant details, scenes or plots in order to not distract or confuse the recipient (Doelker, 1997). Earlier in his piece of 1989 regarding the cultural analysis of TV – which's program bases on moving pictures – he publicised four requirements that need to be fulfilled: propriety, coherence, transparency and empathy. The latter term is supposed to be the most important requirement. It refers to the need for seeing and feeling from the recipient's perspectives when establishing the moving image product (Doelker, 1989). Hertha Sturm, a German scientist for media education and communication psychology, describes these required measures as the *recipient-friendly* or the *recipient-oriented media composition* (Sturm, 2000).

Furthermore, media communication generally is expected to keep its promises, to not overburden nor to underestimate the capability of the receiving audience. In other words, it is to send an adequate amount of information – visually or textual – in order to keep the consumer active. Media is supposed to put the viewer in an active role which means that one is directly addressed and/or directed. The recent term of co-creation relates to exactly this requirement of direct involvement of the consuming person, even to a greater extent in the case of digital media. The experience economy we live in nowadays is shaped by the movement towards putting the consumer in an active role in order to co-create the experience (Prahalad & Ramaswamy, 2004).

However, to arouse attention it is necessary to send contextual stimuli that are familiar to the recipient. Action, violence, sexuality, rush and others are notorious conditions. Accordingly, the style of composition is to adapt. Fast steps, for instance, highlight rush and quick camera movements refer to an action scene. The reason why most recipients might react attentively is the biological code. It refers to the involuntary reaction to phylogenetic signals. In other words, the code makes recipients react the same way, intuitively and according to nature as behavioural patterns are pre-programmed. A well-known example of this phenomenon is the holding of the breath when watching the murder running with a knife towards the victim. The first pre-notional reaction is the same, but the further processing of the stimuli with knowledge and language differs from recipient to recipient (Doelker, 1997).

2.6 Mass Media, the public general and the planning of an agenda

As mentioned in the previous chapter, the first ever that was described as mass media was the newspaper. The general public was and still is characterised with the freedom of expression and the freedom of decision throughout all areas. Though, the reality of media producers obtained the ability to remote the general public. The so-called *agenda setting* indicated a clear and planned structure of the media itself. This function that characterised mass media was called *gatekeeping*. Introduced by Kurt Lewin, the term refers to the ability journalists have when creating selected media content. It highlights the influence on the general public regarding opinion formation by selecting specific topics (Lewin, 1947). What is valued as important in society bases on what topics are represented in the media.

To put it in different words, everything that can be seen and read in the media and intends to reach the mass is valued to be important (Böhn & Seidler, 2014). Luhmann already claimed in 1996 that everything we know about society and the world we do know based on mass media (Luhmann, 1996). Humans do experience subjectively and this subjectivity bases on the perception of the world and everything that is going on in general. All kinds of communication processes, however, shape the way humans perceive single elements in the world. This, in other words, means that media usually tend to determine the disposition of humans towards the natural and cultural environment. As a result, media are to an extent the cause of societal changes. To go a step beyond, this means that mass media obtain the ability to manipulate knowledge and to spread worldviews. Either positively in terms of a positive image formation or negatively in terms of atrocity propaganda (Böhn & Seidler, 2014).

Similar to the agenda-setting that guided media content in terms of printed mass media, a strategic setting is aimed in regard to online media. This content setting or planning is manifested in a content strategy, which describes the development and management of content. The term content planning, however, refers to the exact planning of content, content-wise and its way of distribution amongst several channels. The term is particularly used since the late 1990s (Sherwood, 2018; Wit & Meyer, 1998).

Analogously and digitally, to properly seize all kinds of media, the effects that media has on society and economy have been examined since the middle of the 20th century (Halvorson &

Rach, 2012). In order to seize media for the own benefit, whether it is economically, psychologically or politically, one aims to find out what is required, demanded and expected to achieve the goal that is connected with the usage of certain media (Rockley & Cooper, 2012).

This, however, highlights again the necessity of this master thesis that aims to examine the key characteristics of moving picture media to implement and apply this kind of content into their existing communication strategy. Furthermore, this academic thesis aims to benefit tourism and media scholars, practitioners and researchers to implement this gathered knowledge and to further build on it.

2.7 Conclusion

Until this point, the history of pictures in terms of communication generally was first characterised by the aim of conveying meaning as assumed in the Stone Age, solely by cave paintings.

Later, in the antique epoch, the iconic and detailed representation by human-made pictures was of top priority. Meanwhile, religious belief shaped the way pictures were created and understood in the Middle Age. At this time humans first needed additional information to be able to understand the message and its meaning that is sent by the image. This was reinforced in the Renaissance and even more in the Baroque era when emblems with textual additions posed to be the main media.

The invention of the letterpress revolutionized society due to the increased access to print media. As a result, society became literate and the general public was suddenly informed. Simultaneously, the newspaper became the first mass media product. When the photographic print was invented in the 19th century, media history talked about photojournalism for the first time. Media coverage with photographic pictures became commonplace and pictures generally outpaced the written word again.

Originally discovered by scientists, serial photography poses to be the basis of film media. The film, as the first audio-visual media, could initially only be consumed in public places such as cinemas and in a black and white format. Solely with the proliferation and the technical development of radio, audio-visual media became accessible to the bigger crowd. In other words, radio as the second mass media reinforced the demand for auditive content and was meanwhile driving the technological development of TV. Consequently, the TV turned into the third mass media. As the entertaining, escaping purpose outranked the informational, context and content had to adapt regarding the viewer's preferences. Colours, dramatic composition, as well as the context of the media, had to correlate to the plot.

The foundation of narrative methods that embodied the basis of a film can be referred to as the term *storytelling*. By telling stories humans are able to make sense of the world.

Simultaneously, film montage and continuity editing were additional means to create such stories.

Practitioners indented to seize media efficiently in order to be successful. The setting of an agenda which refers to content management nowadays enables the industry to adapt on the recipient's preferences.

No matter what gadget or media is consumed, advertisements were always part of public mass media due to its financing aspect. Hence, equally to media developments in history, the concept of advertising altered too. Simultaneously, manipulation and falsification were what worried the general public.

Meanwhile, the media industry profited from the researches of neurological science. On that account, the next chapter deals with neurological findings and how they benefit and challenge media.

3 The relation of pictures and neurology

As stated in the previous chapter, the usage of pictures in media became commonplace. Similar to many times before in history, the visual part of media communication has outpaced the written word. This has also neurological reasons which are explained in this following chapter. It starts with the effects of pictures on our neuronal hardware and continues with insights from neuromarketing. How advertisements are able to exert and why brands nowadays fight for attention will be clarified afterwards.

3.1 The neurological effect of pictures

No matter where we go and what we do, our sensory impression is constantly irritated and challenged. Even when we close our eyes, we are confronted by visuals. We not only perceive but think, remember and dream with visual pictures rather than in words (Doelker, 1997).

The question that message senders now deal with is how we actually save pictures in our memory in order to recall them. The answer is that imaginations base on what we perceive with our senses. After we filter information, the brain processes stimuli and eventually stores them in order to recall them (Raab, Unger, & Unger, 2010). If more senses are attached, the brain tends to store information faster. So instead of sending a spoken message only, it is recommended to seize multimedia opportunities (Lindström, 2010; Lindström & Kotler, 2005). Such as moving pictures as they include voice and noise as well as moving visual appeals.

Furthermore, Doelker (1997) claims that humans predominately perceive information when they seem to be relevant to the individual. If the message is manifested with relevance for the recipient, it is more likely to find its way to human memory. If there is information that does not immediately show relevance, the human brain tends to construct its relevance. An example of this phenomenon is clouds or stones that are in a random shape, but the human brain is able to project a representation of something.

This flood of pictures, however, shapes the ability to read and to understand pictures (Doelker, 1997) and thus affects our daily life.

The source of rapid development is in the Information Age which determines again the way we think and communicate. As, whatever changes in media history occur, imprint as permanent modifications of our neural hardware. In other words, our brains adapted to the medial environment (Harnad, 1991; Jung & Matt, 2011) which might argue the media-caused development of our brain. Humans are now characterised by lowered attention spans due to this ubiquity of information. The Swiss communication scientist Doelker claims the flood of pictures as something that humans react to with resistance (Doelker, 1997). A very recent study conducted by scholars of the Technical University of Denmark has proven that this influx of information combined with the fear of missing out, in fact, decreases the ability to focus and hence decreases the time we are able to keep the focus (Lorenz-Spreen, Mønsted, Hövel, & Lehmann, 2019).

Not only technical developments led to ways of communication mainly based on pictures. The visualization of information furthermore enables media consumers to quickly and efficiently understand by utilizing the human visual system (Lankow, Ritchie, & Crooks, 2012). Researchers furthermore investigated that there is no difference in processing visual stimuli than when processing reality. The way our brain reacts to pictures, photography and moving pictures in the form of videos or movies is the same as to real-life objects. It is the same parts of the brain that react and start processing (Bystrina, 1981; Sammer & Heppel, 2015).

What this all amounts to is that humans always intended to communicate visually. First, as there was no other mean or no ability and later on as message senders seized pictures to also approach the non-literate part of society. When practitioners noticed, that attention is easier attracted when using pictures, the usage in media increased. Though, not only the attention is caught, furthermore the ability to easier process and remember justifies to increasingly rely on pictures when sending a message. Thus, also when advertising products and brands. The question to clarify now is what is it that arouses the mind and the brain in order to stick in. As discovered earlier, emotions are the key to success (Böhn & Seidler, 2014; Doelker, 1997; Häusel, 2012). Hence, the following chapter deals with the neurological background of aroused emotions by media. The perception of stimuli and finally to the storage of information, which is essential for brands, is focused.

3.2 Neuromarketing – Ways to arouse the brain

It is the limbic system and in specific, the implicit memory that acts as autopilot in our brains. Sensual perception, stereotypes, automatized behaviour such as walking, association, intuitive decisions and emotions are remoted automatically, without our conscious control. Next to emotions, non-verbal communication, learning and cognitive saving of information, which is especially for brand managers and communication practitioners of great importance, originate from the limbic system. Though it is not an entity in our brains, it refers to a system that connects all areas that were just mentioned (Häusel, 2012). The world-famous neurobiologist Antonio Damasio examined brains after injuries that indicated damage in the implicit system. He discovered, that the brain lacks its ability to make decisions when in those cases emotions could not be aroused anymore (Damasio, 2004). This again highlights the importance of awakening emotions for the purpose of brand memory, image building and many more cognitive processes that affect the decision-making process.

Even more, objects that are not communicated with emotions seem worthless for the recipient and consumer. The stronger the emotions are conveyed, the higher the perceived value of the brand or product (Häusel, 2012).

Consequently, we do now know that emotions are the key to success in terms of communication and further processing of storage. The question arises which exact emotion is it that is to address. Häusel claims that humans have individual focuses in regard to emotions according to motives such as buying motives. He examined an innovative way to segment the target group of recipients based on emotions and motives. *Limbic®* builds on insights of brain research, on psychology and evolutionary biology. It serves the empirical consumer research

and underlies the copyright by Gruppe Nymphenburg Consult AG. Figure 5 shows a map of the Limbic® approach.

The main part that refers to the processing of emotions is the mesolimbic and the reward system (MacLean, 1976). Novelty seeking, sensation seeking, and curiosity root back to this system. It makes us humans to constantly look for new things and to seek diversity which is in terms of tourism of great interest. In the Limbic® approach those values refer to the stimulant. The desire to be stable and save, to avoid anxiety and uncertainty is assigned to the balance system of the Limbic® map. The last of the three systems is about the desire to push oneself, to gain power, status and autonomy instead of heteronomy. Latter is called the dominance system and is together with the stimulant part motive-building. This means, that these two parts are responsible for most actions that base on motives (Häusel, 2012).

A similar study about travel motivations and the resulting destination selection by Gnanapala researched on three main motives that influence the decision-making process in the tourism context (Gnanapala, 2012). Compared to Häusel, he states that a tourist's motivation and behaviour in travelling bases on three instead of only two needs. However, the three systems by Häusel and the three motive factors by McClelland's needs theory are corresponding. McClelland was a social psychologist and built his trichotomy of needs upon Murray's model from 1938 (Murray & Harvard University, 2008). In McClelland's need theory, however, the characteristics of affiliation equal the balance system of the Limbic® map whereas the term achievement and how it is described by McClelland equals the stimuli area of the map. What McClelland described as the power motive is exactly what Häusel expresses with the dominance system (Gnanapala, 2012).

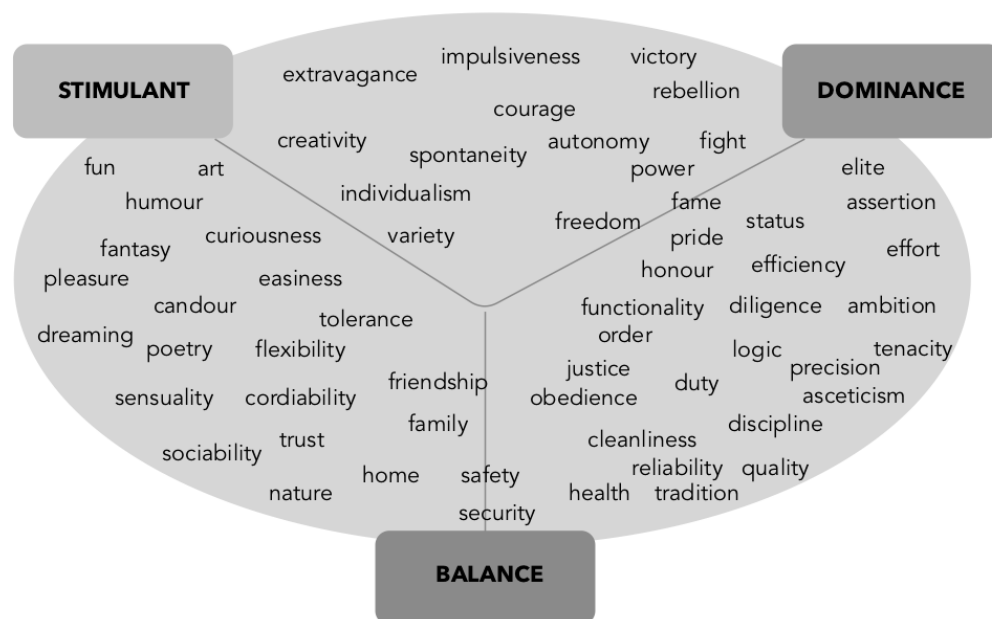


Figure 5 Limbic® map Consult AG; Source: Author, by Gruppe Nymphenburg

Häusel (2012) then argues, that if there are focus areas in terms of motives, then there must be a way to explicitly connect those areas with emotions as they base on preferences. One

that can connect motives and the involved emotions with consumer behaviour can seize this benefit for strategic purposes.

To sum it up, building motives is what practitioners yearn to in terms of communication. As these are the final reasons why consumers chose for certain brands, products or destinations in terms of tourism and what makes them loyal. Such motives root in emotions which are, subsequently, what arouses the brain.

3.3 How advertisements exert and how brands fight for attention

As mentioned earlier, senders or advertisers are constantly confronted with the lowered attention span due to the ubiquity of information (Lorenz-Spreen et al., 2019) and in specific, with the resulting fight for attention by brand advertisers. This fight for attention is claimed to be a concern of the 21st century in the PR and communication industry, driven by the aim to be the one to be recalled (Beißwenger, 2019). In fact, there is advertising in all media: on search engines, on social media, on websites and in all print media, as mailings or in prints such as magazines, newspapers or posters. This sensory overload determines the attention span and lowers it to a maximum of 3,2 seconds in the case of high interest and relevance as with professional journals. Experts describe this side effect as low involvement with ads. Consequently, these very first (milli-)seconds are essential. Within this time, only a very small part reaches the explicit system and thus working memory whilst the rest is processed unconsciously. For brand communication practitioners this means, that the majority is processed in the implicit system and hence without consciousness. However, it is known that the autopilot is the determining processor in regard to buying decisions (Häusel, 2012).

Although many advertisers still operate based on the AIDA-model by Elmo Lewis from 1898, it is to say that most information is perceived incidentally. What is to highlight here is the fact, that en passant information is truly effective due to the low involvement of further processing as no distraction or overstimulation is involved (Häusel, 2012). The psychologist Stewart Shapiro researched this phenomenon and achieved confirmation. Test persons were asked to read texts on computer screens which had advertisements on the screen margins. When asked what brands were advertised, hardly any test person could revise what could be seen. Nevertheless, when later on asked to choose random products, most test persons picked those products which are advertisements they have faced before. Hence, our brains process much more information than we are aware of. In addition to that, our brains, in many cases, are aware of certain aspects such as any news information but lack the ability to remember the source of this information (Häusel, 2012; Shapiro & Krishnan, 2001). Thereof, even though consumers think they are not affected by advertisements, they in fact truly are to different extents (Schacter, 1997).

3.4 Conclusion

The idea of including pictures in the communication mix, in addition to historical developments, roots in neurological reasons as pictures are easier and quicker to process. This realm of applying psychological and neurological insights is called neuromarketing and aims to research and seize what arouses the brain.

It can be concluded that visually expressed information tends to be better stored compared to a solely textual one. The necessity to express information with multimedia opportunities is given. The more senses that are addressed, the easier the attention is caught and the better the information is stored to be recalled later. This led to creative ways of creating messages. Senders seized moving pictures to spread messages and so did the advertising industry to link the attention to a certain brand or product. The ones who know how to attract the audience by catching the attention are the ones that are remembered. This fight for attention made the industry researching motives that influence the decision-making process. And as discussed earlier, relevance and emotions are the key drivers for attention whilst motives can be divided into three systems that are dominance, stimulant and balance.

Therefore, the industry is challenged in terms of communication design. Meanwhile, the way we perceive information and react, constantly shapes. In addition, the ability to keep the attention lowered significantly as a result of the media-caused constant influx of information. To create media representations of reality is especially for the tourism industry of high relevance. Not only due to the fact that the brain activity of processing visual media content equals the processing of the visual experience of reality. Moreover, because the consumption of such content results in travel motivations.

This leads to the necessity to focus on the topic of brand communication in the tourism context as discussed in the next chapter.

4 Modern marketing communications and the branding of destinations

The communication of brands shapes the face of the brand. It determines how potential consumers perceive the brand. Sustainable brand leadership is essential to manifest in consumers' minds (Philip Kotler & Armstrong, 2016; Meenaghan, 1995; Padgett & Allen, 1997). Meanwhile, when observing the industry, one can recognise that over the past years the branding of destinations has emerged. This following chapter highlights the importance of destination branding, including nations. In addition, it explains a practical and scientific proven approach for brand leadership that is needed.

4.1 Destination branding

The original purpose of branding a destination or a place originated from destination-marketing/management organisations, short DMO, and aimed to be clearly differentiated by others (Blain, Levy, & Ritchie, 2005). Regardless of country, region or city, it enables the creation of a positive image in order to be attractive for potential visitors. Besides, it aims to emotionally tie tourists to the tourism destination (Cai, 2002; Gnoth, Baloglu, Ekinci, & Sirakaya-Turk, 2007). The main goals of destination branding are building awareness, making potential visitors choose the destination, achieve satisfaction and loyalty as well as being recommended. In order to achieve a successful destination branding, the responsible organisation acts towards these goals and adapts its marketing activities accordingly (Tasci & Kozak, 2006). Figure 6 gives a summary of reasons to brand a destination.

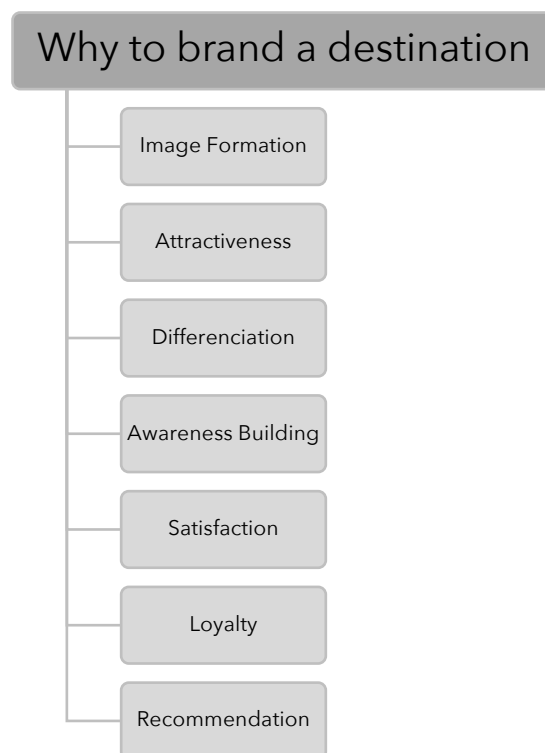


Figure 6 Reasons why to brand a destination
Source: Author

In terms of nations, however, the branding process is a relatively new subject and moreover, a complex and controversial one regarding to Dinnie (2007). It furthermore seems to be different to a slight extent in terms of challenges which is why the subject of nation branding is specified in this thesis in order to in-depth understand what it means to brand destinations, including nations.

4.2 Nation branding

Branding countries incredibly influenced by the media and political activities of a nation. Though, countries around the world have made an effort in developing a national brand strategy to highlight its prominence (Dinnie, 2007). Unbranded countries seem to have difficulties attracting possible tourists and even more, political and economic attention. The image of the country and its reputation very much became crucial for a nation (Van Ham, 2001). Thus, the branding itself is seen as essential for a country (Hankinson, 2009; Kotler & Gertner, 2002; Mihailovich, 2006; Olins, 1999).

Anholt (2007) claimed, that the brand image of a country is similar to the brand image of other destinations and even to products or any other service. Hence, the reasons why to brand a destination that were discussed in the previous chapter and in figure 8 can also be implemented in terms of nations.

Branding a nation refers to the concept of self-representation by trying to achieve a reputation and to gain interest (Szondi, 2008). Another definition by Fan (2006; p.6) defines the process as *“applying branding and marketing communications techniques to promote a nation’s image”*. In addition, the image of a country is shaped by the appearance of a country itself, by art, history, music and other cultural assets and is strongly related to societal situations (Kotler & Gertner, 2002).

Regarding the brand communication of nations, it is necessary to adequately address multiple target groups due to the diversity a nation has to offer which thus results in a relatively complex matter. To communicate this high number of messages a nation possesses, it is essential to apply integrated marketing communications, abbreviated with IMC (Dinnie, 2007). This principle can be defined as a practical unification of all marketing communication tools in order to send one or more consistent and convincing messages (Burnett & Moriarty, 1998). IMC are strongly influenced by the proliferation of media channels and even more by digitalization. It is to implement messages throughout traditional media channels such as TV, radio, newspapers and others as well as to be present online. Though, the necessity of the integration of all marketing communications is not different from other brands (Skinner, 2005).

However, the subject of nation branding seems to be predominantly researched from the tourist’s perspective (Roth & Diamantopoulos, 2009). The perspective of practicing businesses seems to be disregarded (Dore & Crouch, 2003; Laws, Scott, & Parfitt, 2002).

According to Häusel (2012), it is important, that no matter what brand it is, brand leadership has to root in clear management. In the tourism context and for the purpose of this master thesis it is essential to evaluate the importance of moving pictures regarding the destination brand and communication strategy which is crucial for the brand's success. In order to do so, Hans-Georg Häusel suggests managing the core of the brand with its core values first and in the next step, adapting the communication strategy accordingly.

4.3 Brand Code Management

The brand code management by Hans-Georg Häusel bases on insights of neuropsychological brain research claims to be a practical approach for brand leadership, including the fields of brand communication. Its roots lie in the fact that brands are manifested in neuronal networks and thus are dynamic in terms of influence. Only the core of the brand with its meaning is a static stored information. Further conjunctions are influenceable. The brand code management enables practitioners to control the success and coherence of relevance which furthermore influences consumer behaviour. What is important within this approach are the two levels of the brand: First, the level of motives, as discussed in chapter 3.2, which is determined by the limbic system and specifically the amygdala. Second, the brand code itself which communicates the core values of the brand. Those core values, in fact, add autopilot-remoted relevance to the motives. In other words, the brand code bases on values such as status or power while the level of motives refers to the ability to work more efficiently (Häusel, 2012). A brand example hereby would be Apple.

In order to successfully position the brand, the basis (Häusel, 2012) of motives and emotions is the key to influence consumer behaviour. The reason is, as previously explained, the limbic system that guides unconsciously the way we behave (Cohen, Higham, Gössling, & Peeters, 2014; MacLean, 1990).

Before the according motives are clarified, the question of why humans actually consume and why they are loyal to certain brands must be explained. The consumption of products and brands triggers the rewards system in our brains (Burmam, Riley, Halaszovich, & Schade, 2017).

It is said that the purpose of consumption bases on individual motives. Thus, it is to clarify which motive types are determining in order to adapt the message that is sent within the brand leadership. According to the Limbic® map that was explained earlier in chapter 3.2 and figure 5, the same three systems are determining: balance, stimulant and dominance (Häusel, 2012).

Referring to those characteristics that are connected with those systems, the brand itself and its core are accordingly assigned. The German cosmetic brand Nivea, for instance, is clearly positioned along with the balance level as it conveys security, tradition and care. Consequently, brand leadership means to position the brand in terms of communication according to its core values. Respectively to the brand core management, the frame of reference is given by

balance, stimulant and dominance. These three core values, however, correspond to the three motives by McClelland and the Limbic® map that were explained earlier.

However, as already mentioned, brands are dynamic and thus flexible in terms of how relevance is conveyed. In general as well as in the tourism context, brand communication aims to make the consumer “learn” about the relevance (Häusel, 2012).

To conclude the brand core management, it is to say that by applying insights from neuropsychological brain research, a practical and scientific approach for brand managers is given. It enables practitioners to build on communication strategies by focusing on consumer types that are characterised by specific motives. Certain motives are supposed to be the frame of reference for the positioning of the brand as well. Resolutely, the core values of a brand aim to match the motives of consumers or tourists. In other words, the motive of the tourist and consumer as well as the brand core value result from a combination of different scopes of those three systems. In the case of McClelland (1965), Murray (1938) and Häusel (2012), those motives and thus core values are dominance, stimulant and balance.

Figure 7 highlights this connection of the brand core and the Limbic® map that both base on values and match with the consumer motives and types. As stated, those values offer the basis for the brand’s positioning which indicates a frame for brand communication.

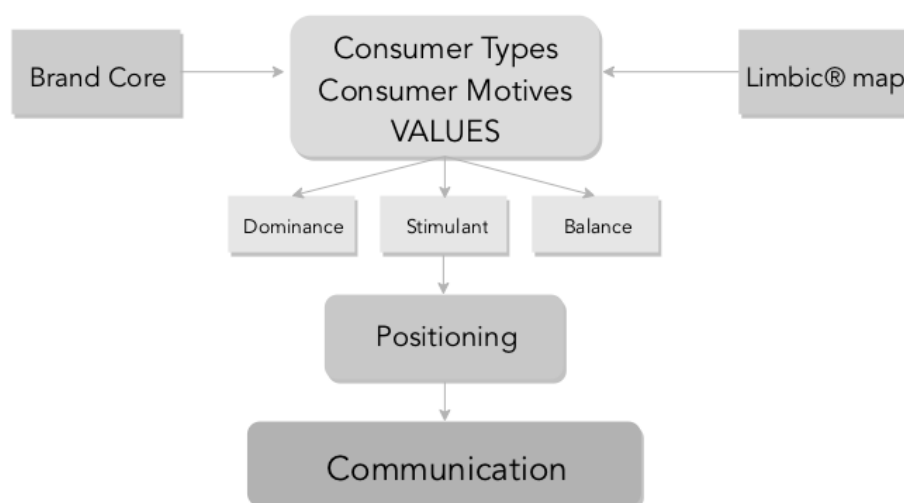


Figure 7 Basis of brand communication; Source: Author

4.4 Modern marketing communications

Due to steady developments in the information and communication industry, communication changed to multiple recipients from multiple sources instead of one source sending to the mass. To put it differently, it moved from one-to-one communication, over one-to-many, many-to-many to many-to-one (Jensen & Helles, 2017). The following key reasons are responsible for this development: the enhancement in technologies in terms of digitalisation and globalisation and the affordability of devices. Accordingly, also the way we communicate

adapted (Keller, 2009). Simultaneously, our travel behaviours changed as well (Buhalis & Leung, 2018; Buhalis & Foerste, 2015). Similar to the open communication regarding many-to-many, the usage of media became multimedia which is described in chapter 2.4 due to several reasons that are not only limited to neurological but historical roots (Böhn & Seidler, 2014). This, however, shaped the advertising industry by challenging it to constantly create innovative messages in order to be the one brand to be recalled (Jung & Matt, 2011).

A cross-media distribution, however, describes a strategic approach to spread messages on several channels. Meaning online and offline. This approach benefits as the audience is confronted with the message steadily: at random times by using different devices (Davidson, 2015). Hence, it is more efficient for practitioners to explicitly target the audience in several ways. Due to the medialisation of marketing communication strategies throughout several channels, the strategic approach of campaigning has emerged. Campaigns, however, refer to *“dramaturgically designed, thematically and time-limited communicative strategies, serving to generate public attention. Campaigns draw on a set of different communicative tools and techniques - promotional and marketing-specific as well as classic PR measures.”* In other words, campaigns aim to generate attention, to build trust in one's credibility, to generate approval for one's intentions and to call for actions such as clicking on a link (Röttger, 1998).

As a result, the consumption of multimedia messages has changed as well. Especially the consumption of moving pictures has drastically increased due to given possibilities and the increased usage of online media. Hence, online moving pictures outpaced moving pictures on classic television. Social platforms such as YouTube, Facebook, MySpace and many more gained enormous popularities during the last decades. Not only amongst digital natives but throughout all age generations (Beißwenger, 2019).

With 1,9 billion monthly users in 2018 and more than 30 million users per day, YouTube counts as the second biggest search engine worldwide. In terms of moving pictures searches, it even ranks as number one as company-internal statistics of YouTube claim. Furthermore, it is said that more than 70 % of all views come from mobile devices (YouTube, 2019).

This highlights the necessity to elaborate on moving pictures in terms of brand communication and in specific, to focus on online moving pictures since online media tends to displace classic moving pictures. Before the user-experience in terms of moving pictures is explained, this thesis aims to elaborate on the topic of brand communication in tourism.

4.5 Effects on brand communication in tourism

It is essential for destination brands to not only communicate the tourist attractions that are offered but also the values and emotional attributes of the destination (Huertas & Marine-Roig, 2015). However, social media such as Facebook, Instagram and many more have substantially changed brand communication (Agarwal, Mondal, & Nath, 2011; Xiang & Gretzel, 2010) and do now count as key tools for effective communication (Munar, 2011). Facebook, however, is still the most used social platform worldwide (Huertas & Marine-Roig, 2014). It is said that

social media platforms became the main predominant ones in terms of information seeking and barely any tourist uses solely traditional forms (Jacobsen & Munar, 2012). This highlights the importance to focus on online and on-screen sources for brand communication of destinations on a national and regional level (Hays, Page, & Buhalis, 2013; Leung, Law, van Hoof, & Buhalis, 2013). The usage of social media, however, seems to be more experimental than strategic according to Hays et al. (2013).

Similar to Häusel (2012), it is said that the brand identity, given by the brand core values, shapes the way a destination communicates (Huertas, 2015). Furthermore, the need for a destination to emotionally attach potential tourists by sending messages is highlighted (Huertas, 2015; Morgan, Pritchard, & Piggott, 2003). Besides, it is aimed to clearly distinguish it from other destinations as already stated by Blain et al., (2005). An empirical study by Laroche et al. (2013) elaborated that posted content on social media platforms may influence the brand-user relationship positively, builds credibility and results in brand loyalty.

4.6 Moving pictures in brand communications

The traditional way of consuming audio-visual content has drastically changed over the past years as explained at the beginning of chapter 4.3 (Stankowski, 1994). The consumption of web-based moving pictures that outpaced TV-based ones has substantially increased. Thomas de Buhr and Stefan Tweraser (2019) explain those technical enhancements that refer to moving pictures and their platforms in specific. They claim that the democratisation of (moving picture) media, which refers to the simple and ubiquitous usage of moving pictures, seems to be one main cause.

Besides that, the highly improved broadband connections and enhanced storage possibilities are responsible for this rapid development in terms of moving pictures (de Buhr & Tweraser, 2019). Thomas Mickeleit adds low or even free costs for the usage of multimedia and network technologies. Thus, the costs for the production as well as the proliferation of moving pictures have decreased rapidly (Mickeleit, 2019). These lowered expenditures are summed up as low/free costs for technologies as seen in figure 8 which underlines those causes visually. Social media as a main driving force in regard to moving pictures is added as well and will be explained in chapter 4.6.

Given the above, new devices, new services and steady trend developments challenge the moving picture industry. The interest in visual content is predominant, especially in the advertising industry as well as on online platforms of enormous popularity. Visual appeals such as pictures or moving pictures do support advertisement recall (Beißwenger, 2019; Jung & Matt, 2011). Likewise researched in the context of tourism (Hays et al., 2013; Leung et al., 2013).

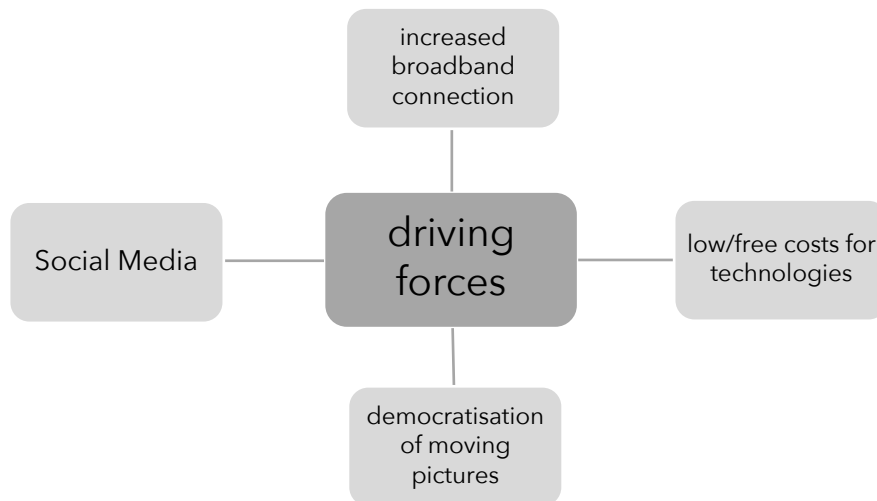


Figure 8 Driving forces for increased moving picture consumption; Source: Author

Additionally, what can be visually perceived, tends to be more credible as humans tend to believe in what they have seen with their own eyes. In terms of purchasing, this results in more certainty as moving pictures provide orientation (Beißwenger, 2019) and create relevance to the one consuming the content (Häusel, 2012). Besides, such content tends to catch recipients' attention easier and influence the decision-making (Graap, 2015; Jung & Matt, 2011; Lee & Shin, 2014; Teng, Ye, Yu, & Wu, 2014).

Moreover, moving pictures are placed on websites to optimize search engine results. Such content resulted in an increase in the length that website visitors stayed on the webpage. In addition, the conversion tends to be higher and brands tend to be perceived as more credible. Important to mention is that consumers tend to watch moving picture content formats to feel more secure in their decision-making when it comes to purchasing a product or a service (Graap, 2015).

A study by See-To et al. (2012) discovered that the consumption of moving picture content differs based on the device used. While the content on mobile screens, on the first hand, has to sensory attach consumers, arousing emotions is of paramount importance in terms of desktops. The limited size of mobile screens, as well as the higher interruption rate by other services such as messages or calls, determines the requirement of satisfying the sensory experience foremost. In addition, the attention span of the users is lower than compared to desktop screens. In contrast, bigger screens, higher attention spans and thus a higher level of engagement would enable the user to immerse more likely (See-To, Papagiannidis, & Cho, 2012).

When using mobile devices, mainly the purpose of enjoyment or entertainment is achieved (See-To et al., 2012). Enjoyment, in this case, refers to the extent to which video consumption is perceived to be enjoyable (Davis, Bagozzi, & Warshaw, 1992). Engagement, however, refers to the psychological immersion and the corresponding avoidance of stimuli outside the

media that distract the recipient. In other words, engagement describes the state of not being “*captured by another medium*” (Bhattacharjee, 2001).

To illustrate the benefits of moving pictures as part of the communication mix, figure 9 offers a summary.

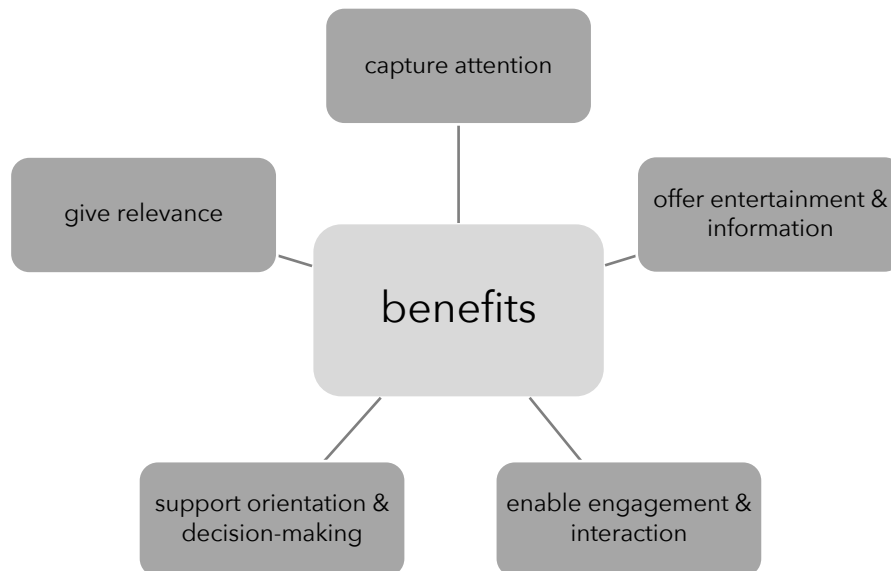


Figure 9 Benefits of using moving pictures; Source: Author

However, more than half of all mobile traffic roots in moving picture consumption as discovered in 2015. Numbers are assumed to be even higher in 2019 (Graap, 2015). Therefore, an understanding of web-based moving pictures and in specific, of moving pictures on social media is needed.

4.7 Moving pictures and social media

These driving forces as explained in figure 8 not only encourage practitioners but users to increasingly create moving pictures. Due to obliterating frontiers, senders and recipients are not anymore clear to distinguish (Mielau & Schmiegelow, 2019).

As Pine & Gilmore (1998) already stated and Prahalad & Ramaswamy (2004) supported, the society moves towards an experience economy since consumers strive for unique and memorable experiences. The desire to co-create and to involve resulted in a “lean-forward” attitude and substituted the “lean-back” consumption of media. To put it differently, consumers became prosumers by literally leaning forward towards the screen rather than backwards in front of a classic TV and began to engage. Media users or prosumers determine their behaviour and decide when to consume content depending on their preferences. Whenever they want and independent from where the recipient is located (Mickeleit, 2019).

Social media, however, enabled the prosumer to involve and to receive personalised content and, additionally, to interact socially. Thus, social media influences enormously brand presence and how it is perceived (Mielau & Schmiegelow, 2019).

Correspondingly, the number of UGC expanded enormously and left remarkable footprints in terms of credibility due to transparency and interestingness (Yu, Carlsson, & Zou, 2014). Nonetheless, some practitioners believe that professionally created content is constantly rising and seems to be more popular than user-generated ones (de Buhr & Tweraser, 2019).

Even though the usage of social media has increased drastically and has influenced the way a brand communicates, it is crucial to send messages cross-medially as explained in chapter 4.3.

Daft and Lengel (1986), however, discovered that the consumption of moving pictures may result in a higher level of involvement and even of immersion. The overall “golden” aim in terms of the usage of moving pictures would be the flow theory. This concept describes the state of complete consciousness at which recipients are fully immersed in the activity and additionally enjoying the act (Csikszentmihalyi, 1977). The term flow can be described equally as immersion (Michailidis, Balaguer-Ballester, & He, 2018). Similarly, Pine & Gilmore describe the term immersion as a state of *“becoming physically or virtually part of the experience”* (1998, p.31).

4.8 Moving pictures in tourism

Visual content such as photos and moving pictures, in general, engage tourists (Marlow & Dabbish, 2014). It is important to mention that researches on visual content in the tourism context mainly focused on travel photography (Jansson, 2013; Urry & Larsen, 2011; Haldrup & Larsen, 2009; Jansson, 2002) while moving pictures seem to be disregarded.

A Google report of 2016 stated that every month, more than 100 million YouTube visitors are potential tourists¹. It is estimated that 64 % of all people consuming travel-related moving pictures do so when thinking of any travel plans². Three in five recipients that watch moving picture content of a destination do so in order to narrow down a specific destination³. Interestingly, two-thirds of all travel-related videos are consumed via a smartphone⁴.

¹ Google/Ipsos MediaCT, “The 2015 Travelers Road to Decision,” base: leisure travelers n=3,500; base: business travelers n=1,500, Aug. 2015

^{2,3} Google/Ipsos MediaCT, “The 2015 Traveler’s Road to Decision,” base: U.S. leisure and business travelers who watched/commented on travel-related video, leisure n=1,230, business n=87, Aug. 2015

⁴ YouTube Data, U.S., classification as “top travel-related” videos was based on the top 100,000 videos using public data such as headlines, tags, etc., and may not account for every such video available on YouTube. Mobile devices include smartphones and tablets. Jan.–Mar. 2015 vs. Jan.–Mar. 2016

Important to add, the top-used keywords to search for travel-related moving pictures are destinations' names (Google, 2016).

Several academic studies pay attention to moving pictures in terms of brand communication. Neuhofer et al. (2012) researched the enhancement of tourism experiences by the implications of technologies. Within this study, destinations that seize moving pictures to communicate the brand were discussed. Potential visitors in Thailand, for instance, benefited from a technology-enhanced destination experience already in the pre-stage by consuming travel-related content such as moving pictures that were posted online. The website explicitly featured multimedia content to enhance the virtual experience in order to inspire potential new tourists to visit the country. Another example would be Montreal as the destination for a while featured interactive moving pictures on the website in order to let the website visitor actively pre-experience the tourist offer before actually going there. This study highlights the fact that content, and in specific moving picture content plays an essential role in the inspiration phase of potential new visitors.

4.9 Conclusion

Within modern marketing communications of destinations, including nations, it can be concluded that branding aims to extract the following advantages: to build awareness for the destination, to be clearly differentiated by others and to appear attractive to potential visitors. This may result in satisfaction and loyalty and thus, creates the basis of image formation.

However, the communication of a brand, either product or service brand, needs clear management. The starting point of such is the brand core and its values that need to match the values and motives of the consumer for him/her to create relevance. Those values regarding the brand core and to the consumers, can be assigned to the three systems of the Limbic® Map: dominance, stimulant and balance. This indicates a clear positioning of the brand which is the needed starting point for brand communication (Figure 6).

Important to note is, that the consumption and thus the creation of moving pictures increased enormously due to several driving forces which are social media, the improved broadband connection, information and communication technologies at low or no cost as well as the democratization of moving pictures (Figure 7).

At the same time, practitioners need to pay attention that consumption nowadays moves to the level of an experience proposition. This fact underlines the necessity for cross-media communication, especially to include social media activities into their communication mix since consumers actively search for interaction and engagement and are able to remote their media consumption regarding their preferences. It can be any device, any channel at any time and independent from the location. Being present amongst all media, online and offline, enables the brand to fully engage with the consumer and vice versa.

According to YouTube statistics, 64 % of all YouTube videos watched are travel-related and three in five do actually watch moving pictures to narrow down their travel options. It is stated that moving pictures do offer travel inspiration and motivations and, in addition, enable orientation in terms of decision-making which highlights the importance of the overall communication mix (YouTube, 2019).

However, moving pictures seem to be only elaborated from tourist perspectives. Studies focused on the enhancement of tourist experience due to moving pictures while the sender perspective, however, seems to be disregarded. Especially in terms of brand communication practitioners. Consequently, this thesis focuses on sender perspectives in terms of visual brand communication with moving pictures. To elaborate on this sender perspective, experts from the industry, either in the context of tourism or from the (brand) communication industry were interviewed. The following chapter addresses the conceptual framework as well as the empirical part of this academic thesis.

5 Conceptual framework

The conceptual framework of this thesis offers a derivation of concepts, that have proven their ability to be adapted based on the literature review. Those concepts support the guiding research question of this thesis and facilitate the creation of the interview guide for the methodology.

The communication model by Schulz von Thun (1981) adds two perspectives to the framework: the sending and the receiving perspective concerning a message. The sending perspective refers to the one addressing the brand message in this case moving pictures whilst the receiving perspective poses to be the target. In between, there are requirements that communication is ought to fulfil such as the necessity to communicate amongst several media channels (Davidson, 2015).

Furthermore, the task to convey relevance is given (Doelker, 1997; Häusel, 2012) which is described with the condition of being relevant or useful to what is happening or being talked about referencing the Oxford Dictionary.

Moreover, as stated by Doelker (1989), the ability to see and feel from the recipient's perspective is of great importance. This ability refers to the term empathy (Doelker, 1989) towards the recipients and is needed in order to understand the values and motives of the addressed consumer and to adapt the message and to eventually create emotions (Böhn & Seidler, 2014; Doelker, 1997; Häusel, 2012). Emotions, however, count as the driving force of motivations. Besides, they are of great interest due to their universal comprehensibility (Ekman, 1970).

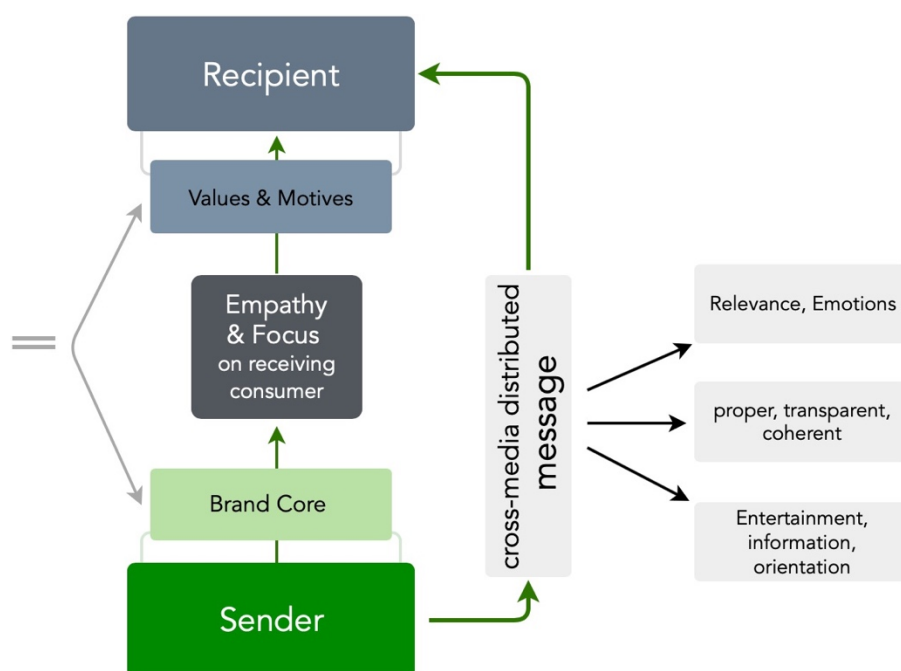


Figure 10 Conceptual framework; Source: Author

Communication, moreover, should be proper, coherent amongst all media channels and transparent based on the sender's origin (Doelker, 1997). In addition, recipient-friendly and oriented to the consumer (Sturm, 2000), which again refers to empathy. Only when fulfilling these requirements that premise focussing on the target group, senders can offer orientation that supports the decision-making process (Beißwenger, 2019). Besides offering information, it is important to entertain and to make the recipient enjoy the media consumption (Davis et al., 1992).

Figure 10 summarises the key concepts introduced above – (1) relevance, (2) emotions, (3) empathy, (4) entertainment in the context of a sending and a receiving perspective – that aim to give marketers an insight into brand communication with moving pictures. Additionally, this framework of concepts supports the creation of the interview guide that is used for the methodological part of this thesis. Understanding these different concepts should help practitioners in the design and implementation process of moving pictures within the communication mix.

6 Research methodology

This master thesis aims to contribute to the knowledge about brand communication in tourism research by focusing on the key characteristics of moving pictures and its integration for destination tourism brands. For this purpose, an exploratory qualitative research by using a semi-structured interview guide is conducted. Qualitative expert interviews that aim to answer the following research questions and sub questions are accomplished:

RQ 1. What are the key characteristics of moving pictures in brand communication?

SQ 1. How could these key characteristics be integrated into the brand communication of destination brands?

SQ 2. How do brand communication practitioners assess the future of moving pictures in brand communication?

Following, the used methodology is explained. Afterwards, the empirical part continues with an explanation of the research design, followed by the sample. The chapter then continues with a description of the interview guide and finally, the qualitative content analysis of the conducted research is described.

6.1 Expert interviews

The qualitative approach of expert interviews has been chosen since this method is beneficial for the purpose of researching subjective business matters such as the operation with moving pictures. It enables a focus on the diversity of perspectives regarding this subject (Craig & Douglas, 2001; Gurău & Ranchhod, 2005; Halinen & Törnroos, 2005; Freeman & Cavusgil, 2007).

Exploratory expert interviews count as an efficient method for qualitative data gathering. Such interviews require validation and a fundamental literature review (Bogner, Littig, & Menz, 2009) and furthermore, aim to verify reliable data. The direct benefit of this method is to effectively and quickly obtain explicit and up-to-date knowledge (Pfadenhauer, 2009) which reinforces the choice of this method. This rapid access to data poses to be the main advantage for empirical social research in general and additionally enables reconstruction of the latent content of meaning (Bogner et al., 2009).

6.2 Research design

For this thesis, the worldview of constructivism has been chosen as the philosophical paradigm. As Creswell (2014) explains, a constructivist approach aims to understand the world in which individual humans develop subjective perspectives. The focus of this academic work is on the different views concerning moving pictures that pose to be the basis of this constructivist research.

In order to achieve the targets of the study, it was necessary to carry out a literature review that was premised to conduct empirical research (Bryman, 2012). As a first step, an interview guide was established, followed by the conduction of the qualitative interviews. The collection of the primary data takes place in Austria by interviewing experts operating in this country. In the next step, the interviews that have been recorded with consent from the interviewees, have been transcribed. Lastly, a qualitative content analysis using Mayring's approach is done. Figure 11 shows the process of the empirical research of this master thesis.

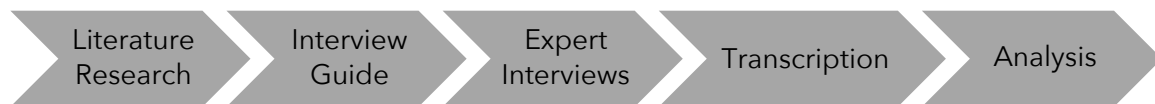


Figure 11 Research process; Source: Author

6.3 Expert sample and profile

The primary research utilized an expert sample that was chosen based on a pre-determined criterion for the selection of experts. This pre-defined criterion, however, required participants to be experts in operating with moving pictures. Eight experts were interviewed over a period of eight weeks. The interviews lasted between 44 minutes and 100 minutes. The following table summarizes the hard facts regarding the conducted interviews.

Table 1 Interview details; Source: Author

Number of experts	8
Expert's country of origin	Austria, Germany
Expert's country of current operation/employment	Austria, partially international for certain periods
Interview course	May 20 th and July 5 th , 2019.
Average interview time	49 minutes

Furthermore, special attention in terms of the expert sample was given in order to have responses from experts operating in different industries – tourism related, and non-tourism related but practicing in the field of communication. The respondents were approached via email and the interviews were conducted either personally or via an e-conference using zoom.us. Table 1 gives an overview of the expert sample including their field of profession. An exact description for each expert is attached in the appendix B. *E* in “brackets” in addition to a number poses to be an abbreviation and refers to the statements in the analysis part of this thesis.

Table 2 Expert sample; Source: Author

Profession	Expert Name
Independent director, producer, filmmaker at <i>dallingerfilm</i>	L. Dallinger. (E1)
Business consultant, former market manager Middle East & Great Britain, Head of Marketing Germany at <i>Austria Tourism</i>	K. Ehrenbrandtner (E2)
Independent filmmaker, content creator, director and editor at <i>Jonathan Forsthuber Filmproduktion</i>	J. Forsthuber (E3)
Director, senior lecturer and department leader in film at <i>Salzburg University of Applied Sciences</i>	T. Fuhrmeister (E4)
Management, spokeswoman, editor at <i>D5 Productions GmbH</i>	M. Geiregger (E5)
Creative art and strategy director at <i>TOWA digital</i>	M. Kuhn (E6)
Filmmaker at <i>D5 Productions GmbH</i>	F. Pollstätter (E7)
Director, marketer, journalist at <i>diego5 Studios</i>	S. Thier (E8)

6.4 Interview guide

The interview guide that is used to conduct the explorative research is semi-structured. It aims to elaborate on essential aspects that could not be acquired in the literature review. However, certain aspects that are highlighted in the conceptual framework (figure 10) are in focus of this interview guide as well as it is to find out whether experts do pay attention to those concepts that are said to be crucial in terms of moving pictures.

Semi-structured interviews enable the interviewer to be flexible while interviewing and to adapt the questions according to the context given (Bryman, 2012). Throughout the guide, solely open questions are to be asked due to the increased validity of responses. Furthermore, open questions are seen to be appropriate for exploratory studies (Aberbach & Rockman, 2002). Each interview guide is furthermore slightly adapted according to the expertise of each interviewed expert. The aim is to gather in-depth knowledge regarding moving pictures by elaborating several perspectives.

The first part of the interview aims to warm-up the conversation and to welcome an open interview atmosphere. Afterwards, the topic of moving pictures is focused by elaborating the expert's individual approach to projects with moving pictures, depending on their field of expertise. The main part aims to acquire moving pictures and its application as well as the benefits for brand communication. Single elements and characteristics such as length, composition, colours, plot, course, speed, in-picture elements as well as the devices used to consume the content are then to be compiled. The author then clarifies the requirements and opportunities concerning the key concepts based on the literature review: emotions, relevance and how to arouse each of them. Finally, the question of how to target the consumer as well as the relevance of targeting is asked followed by future assessment regarding moving pictures. The exact interview guideline is attached in the appendix A.

However, the nature of the open-end questions results in several distinctive responses. Therefore, the first step of the analysis afterwards is to classify similar primary answers into broader categories in order to facilitate the qualitative content analysis by Mayring, and furthermore, to answer the research questions. Thus, the following figure 12 explains the categories that are used in this thesis.

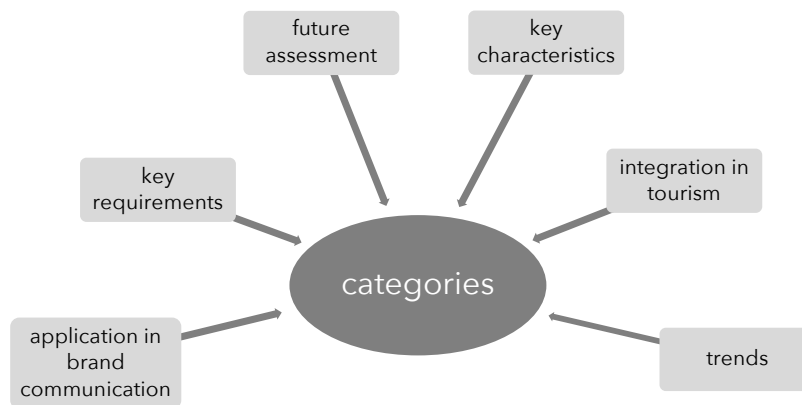


Figure 12 Categories for qualitative content analysis, Source: Author

6.5 Data analysis

Each conducted interview needs to be transcribed in order to do the content analysis. The analysis based on Philipp Mayring (2010) requires the unwrought statements to be categorized as mentioned in 6.4 and, consequently, to be paraphrased. In the fourth step, the paraphrased statement needs to be summarized in a short version. These short versions are attached in appendix C. The following table 3 gives an example of how the author conducted the content analysis with Excel:

Table 3 Example of qualitative content analysis based on P. Mayring; Source: Author

Transcript	Cat.	Paraphrasis	Short Version	Summary
E5: For branding, not performance. The higher the funnel (awareness, consideration, conversion), the more relevant moving images are. So it's important for awareness and to communicate an image. I manage to generate attention better with moving images than with an image.	Application in Brand Communication	With moving pictures one can create an image, increase awareness, build consideration and achieve conversion; and catch the attention for my brand/product easier than with single pictures	to achieve image formation, awareness and consideration for the brand; catch attention for brand easier	image formation, awareness building, consideration for brand; easier to catch attention of recipient

7 Results and discussion

The following chapter highlights and discusses the findings of the conducted research. Those findings are, as mentioned above, categorized. It starts with the general applications of moving pictures in brand communication and follows with the category of “key characteristics”. Afterwards, the integration of moving pictures in the context of tourism is mentioned and lastly, the findings concerning expert’s future assessments are listed. Chapter 8 then concludes those findings for practical implications.

7.1 Application in brand communication

This research aims to elaborate on moving pictures as part of the brand communication mix, in specific tourism destination brands. In terms of application, three main fields have been revealed which are shown in figure 13. It shows that by applying moving pictures in the communication mix, strategic business goals can be achieved, the brand’s relationship to the recipient can be built as well as enhanced and value for the customer/tourist can be created.

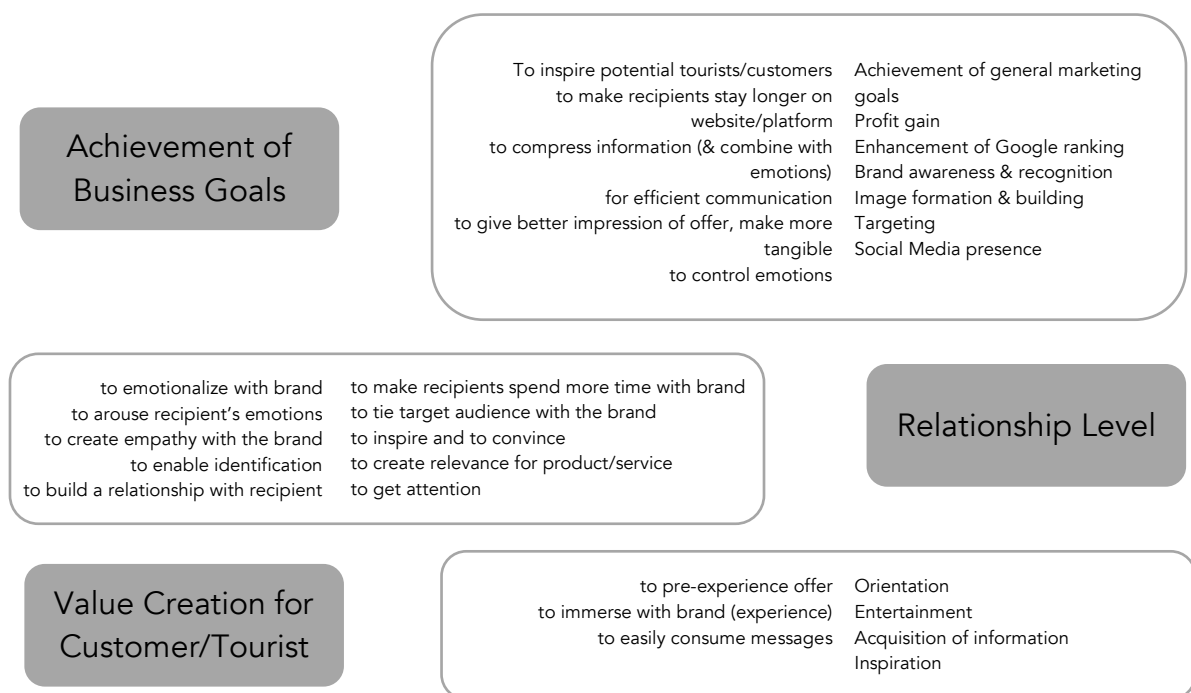


Figure 13 Application in brand communication; Source: Author

Those findings are partially equal to such of the literature review. For example, Doelker (1997) and Böhn & Seidler (2014) already claimed to arouse emotions and to emotionalize the target audience with the brand.

In addition to the findings based on the literature review by Cai (2002), Gnoth et al. (2007) and Tasci & Kozak (2006), which argued that by applying moving pictures as a content format in brand communication, general marketing goals such as profit gain, image formation and building can be achieved. The qualitative research, however, has shown additional results

which are the enhancement of the Google Ranking, the opportunities for explicit targeting and the ability to build a relation to the recipient. Thus, the finding regarding website performance confirms the statement by Graap (2015). Though, the research has shown that no specific goals are said to be only achieved by moving pictures. Nonetheless, the ability to efficiently communicate and to thus aim general marketing goals is given.

In terms of social media and the brand's presence on such platforms, the conducted research has shown that it is crucial for a brand to be present on several social platforms with multimedia content formats, which include moving pictures. Platforms such as Instagram TV do require moving picture formats only. The interviews have shown that moving pictures tend to determine whether a social media account is trustworthy, reliable and convincing. The importance of being present on such platforms in terms of inspiration and information seeking was already argued by Jacobsen & Munar (2012) and in addition, as a space to strategically tie the customer to the brand by co-creating with users as claimed by researchers (Benckendorff et al., 2014; Fisk, 2015; Neuhofer & Buhalis, 2013). For practitioners, this means to invest in having a strong media presence and to gain insights regarding user behaviour on social media channels.

In order to convince potential customers for the brand's product or service, it is to apply content formats in the brand communication mix that enables to pre-experience the brand's offer. This finding confirms the experience proposition which was already argued by Pine & Gilmore (1998) and Prahalad & Ramaswamy (2004). Additionally to the findings by Neuhofer et al. (2012) regarding the virtual experience co-creation, experts stated that moving pictures are said to facilitate an experience prior to the actual (on-site) consumption by giving a deeper impression of what to expect, as well as by giving orientation and providing information in an easy-to-consume format. Moreover, moving pictures count as a more entertaining format compared to others and thus recipients tend to prefer to consume branded media even though it is obviously advertisement.

“ [...] because moving images they are, in comparison to print and pictures, much more powerful in reaching people's emotions. And if you think about tourism, they also have the advantage that they can give a customer a very clear picture about the product which is the tourism experience.” – (E2)

Regarding the explicit targeting of media content, the research has given insights that could not be investigated within the literature that was reviewed beforehand. Results show, that in terms of social media platforms, the ability to pre-set the desired target group enhances the media performance. In addition, qualitative research has shown a very interesting aspect of targeting the silver society, which is becoming more acquainted with technology usage.

This target audience is therefore characterized by great potential as it can be reached by applying moving pictures in the brand communication as the following quote highlights:

“ [...] such as the target group 60+ and 50+. These target groups are a very strong and large target group on the Internet, which has not yet been properly discovered, but it is there and needs content. This older audience would be happy if they got content which does not need to be read. This is a huge target group that exists and that will always be there and have time. An audience that also tends to have visual impairments.” – (E8)

This means that by applying moving pictures, practitioners might be able to reach target audiences that would prefer consuming such multimedia content formats especially due to its simple processing which seems to correspond to the needs of either elderly or very young audiences.

7.2 Key characteristics

In order to answer the research question and to find out what characterizes moving pictures in the context of brand communication, it was necessary to discuss requirements on moving pictures as well as trends that affect the characteristics of moving picture media. The following figure gives a visual representation of the key characteristics:

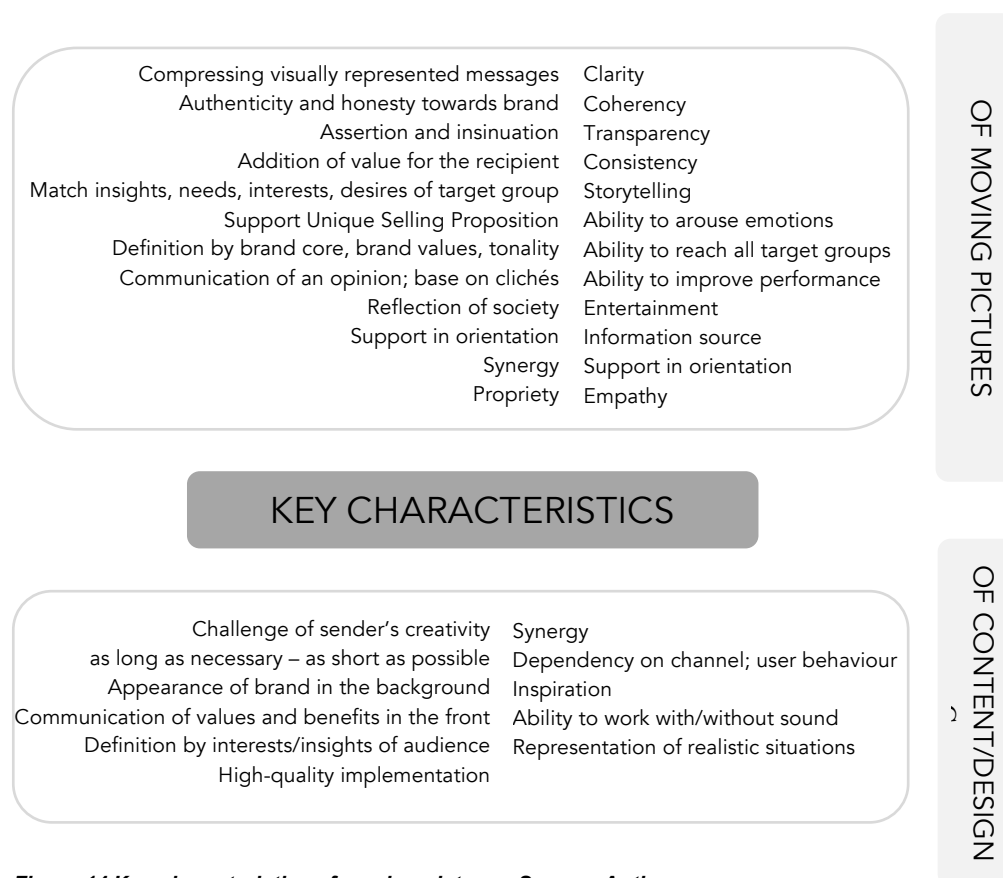


Figure 14 Key characteristics of moving pictures, Source: Author

The interviews have shown that moving pictures tend to be more powerful and convincing media than any other. Implementing moving pictures as part of the brand's communication mix is said to be costly and time-consuming, especially if strategically adapted to the brand's essential.

Results have furthermore confirmed findings by Doelker (1989) which argue that the brand should be transparent in order for recipients to obviously understand whom the sender of the media is. However, the interviews have shown that it is crucial to keep the brand itself in the background. Focusing on the target audience and not on the brand is of top priority as some experts claimed.

The research has proven, that branded moving pictures, thus, count as enrichment for both, the recipient as it is able to consume customized content and the brand, and the sender since it is able to give a realistic impression of what to expect from the brand. The enhancement of the customer's experience by virtual implications of multimedia content confirms partially results of Neuhofer et al. (2012). By doing so, it is entertaining and informing the recipient which is done after the rules of storytelling rather than by listing product or service facts. The following quote supports these findings:

"The moving image is close to what people experience every day, what you see and hear. It has always moved people, emotionally. The moving picture holds the world in front of your eyes like a mirror, so you can quickly identify with it." - (E4)

Moreover, moving pictures are characterized by being designed with high-quality and coherently to the brand's core values and tonality. In addition, by being adapted to the target group's user behaviour, needs, interests and desires. Brands are said to adapt the language of the target audience. By putting the brand in the background, the content fully focuses on the target audience and the brand keeps a consistent appearance. These findings do not differ from those of the literature review, such as Sturm (2000) and Doelker's (1989) research of the importance to act recipient-oriented and recipient-friendly and Häusel (2012) who highlights the need to operate according to the brand core. Thus, practitioners are said to engage with the brand and its core, as well as with the target group that it aims to reach; and lastly, to find a position in the market.

However, the conducted research has proven that the focus on the target audience and the individual customization regarding the brand's needs do not rank first for some practitioners. This is to be seen critical as they have proven within the interviews to be aware of those requirements. Some experts claim to fully rely on the client's briefing instead of researching the target group on their own or relying on their expertise. Practitioners operate along the lines of *"the client is king"* instead of consulting the client.

The quote listed below metaphorically underlines this finding:

“The point is that there are cardiac surgeons and parcel delivery providers in the industry. The cardiac surgeon treats the problem, analyses it and tries to find a solution to this problem by fully assisting the patient. The parcel delivery service though, brings the parcel from A to B, according to the order, and delivers it at a fixed time. The creative industry is similar to the parcel service providers but should act more like cardiac surgeons.” – (E4)

The research has furthermore demonstrated the fact that existing literature based on the motive systems by Häusel (2012) do not seem to apply for practitioners. The author assumes, that these findings and in-depth motives investigations are too detailed and therefore, do not seem to be practical. The study has shown that demographic segmentation and psychographic characteristics give insight are determining the content and creation of moving pictures.

Interesting to mention is, that all interviewed experts agree on the necessity to prove synergy to all elements which are images, formal aesthetics. Furthermore, all interviews have shown that moving pictures are no longer characterized by cinema graphic structures as reviewed by literature. On the contrary, the structure of moving pictures is solely based on the channel that distributed the moving picture, the brand core, the target audience and the client's briefing. No matter which channel, its aim is to catch the recipient's attention, build tension and arouse curiosity in order to continue watching. These findings, however, prove that experts operate based on the AIDA-model by Elmo Lewis (1898).

„[...] I have to try to capture the needs of the target group with an insight and hang on to this insight in communication. That's what my idea comes from [...] Marketers must know, that they fight for a limited good that is (recipient's) attention.” - (E6)

When communicating a brand, the uniqueness of the product or service should primarily be portrayed with clarity, aiming not to be mistaken by any other offer. This is challenging the creativity of practitioners and defines moving pictures as something that is rather implemented by professionals.

Regarding the content and the design of moving pictures the conducted research highlights characteristics to be defined close to reality and society. Brand communication is said to be easy to consume and easy to identify with and, in addition, to reflect current trends and happenings such as feminist movements or social responsibilities.

This makes brands having an opinion that is publicly communicated, and that enables customers to potentially identify and emotionalize with the brand.

“Brands are increasingly defining themselves towards social responsibility, be it the environment, for example. You don't just define yourself more as a brand or the performance of the brand, but you communicate a basic attitude.” (E4)

In order to send messages reduced to the essential which is required to be efficient and to be easily-consumed, the content often bases on clichés that are explicitly seized by practitioners.

By following the requirement that moving pictures are expected to work with and without sound, they count as a universal media that is able to reach all target groups, independent of age or origin. In contrast, some experts claim music to be an essential element when it comes to arousing emotions which seems to be contracting the statement mentioned before.

When asking the experts about current trends that affect moving pictures, findings have shown that spectacular camera works, and perspectives characterize the uniqueness and success of moving pictures. Currently, it is nature scenes, focus in humans and the usage of technology to produce innovative moving picture media. Gadgets such as drones or virtual reality technologies and 360° media do not only count as recent trends but moreover, as an ability to offer an immersive experience in the pre-purchase phase.

“You manage to catch the viewer. Either through technology or through powerful images. With very good resolution and whatever is characterized by being outside of the box and thus, special such as underwater shots or amazing drone shots.” - (E2)

Similar to other moving pictures, pre-experience opportunities with VR aim to inspire, inform and entertain the receiver. Lastly, investing in a strong social media presence is claimed to be essential for brands. Such presence requires multimedia content, including moving pictures. It is, therefore, necessary for brands to invest in multimedia content creation.

Regarding requirements of moving pictures, it is furthermore important to mention the necessity to continuously follow a clear goal and to not just implement moving pictures for the purpose of having such content formats. It requires to follow the brand's strategy.

7.3 Integration in tourism

When applying those insights in the context of tourism and the brand communication of destination brands, including nations, findings regarding goals to achieve and ways of integration could be elaborated. Figure 15 shows those findings which serve to answer the sub research question I:



Figure 15 Integration in tourism, Source: Author

When having a closer look at destinations, practitioners are able to make potential tourists long for the place. Thus, by applying (moving) pictures, brands can inspire recipients to choose them for their destinations. Moreover, this media reaches potential customers, that would otherwise not choose to consume media content of a specific brand. What results from these findings is the need to invest in media content production, especially multimedia content and to elaborate on the diversity of the destination to theme it. It is to focus on aesthetical representations, spectacular camera perspectives and the humans behind the offered tourism service.

By applying the communication model by Schulz von Thun (1981), those findings can be integrated within the four sides of the message, which in the case of this thesis refers to the moving picture (Figure 16): The destination would reveal itself as being a destination to visit and might add the information of offering experiences based on the target group's interests such as hiking or cultural city travelling. The relationship level of the message would indicate a relation built upon emotions and they match with the recipient's values, sent with the moving picture format. Lastly, the destination's appeal would then inspire the receiver to book a stay and to actually experience the tourism offer.

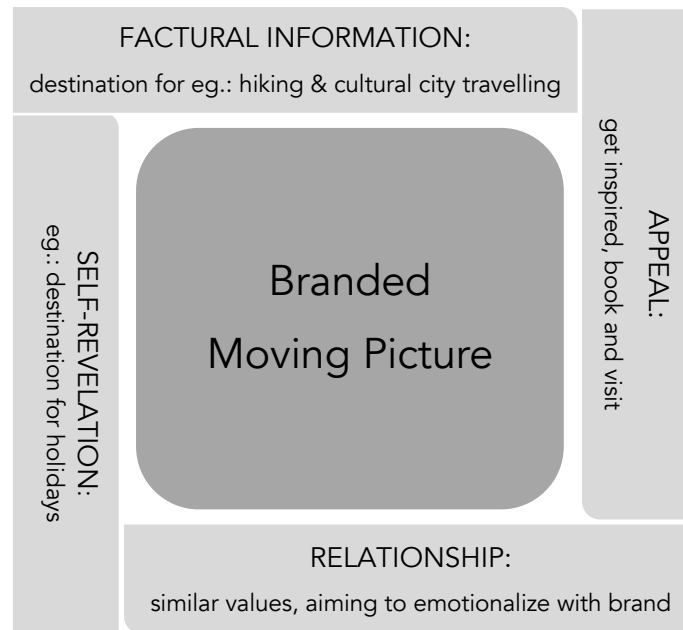


Figure 16 Application of communication model after Schulz von Thun; Source: Author

The interviews have shown that the tourism industry, in general, seems to lack in moving picture media due to the lack of acknowledgment for such media content. It furthermore seems to underestimate its ability to create relevance and to emotionalize with the tourist. Supported by a misunderstanding of the target groups and lacking empathy for their desires, needs and user behaviour.

“That tourism has not yet fully understood how it presents itself with moving images.

*Back to the hotel (a project I have worked on): a 58-year-old hotel manager
will be convinced a video of a hotel tour would make sense.*

*I dare to suggest that he was unaware of how young people are getting
information today and what they are interested in.” – (E1)*

Nonetheless, all experts mentioned the importance of having such media in order to accomplish strategic goals such as awareness and recognition building as well as gaining profit from visits. Furthermore, it is said that especially in tourism, the opportunity of including moving pictures should be seized as it enables to compress many messages in one format and to represent the diversity of a destination at the same time. In addition, one can aim for several target groups at the same time by including various aspects of interest.

“It is important to convince with very nice pictures. There are many possibilities in tourism.

*To highlight a country's (or destination's) diversity, that's the biggest task. Images and
especially moving images tell about the diversity of a country much more than a text.” – (E5)*

Similar to findings regarding the application in general, it is to explicitly focus on the target tourist by designing the media according to the destination brand and its values.

Regarding challenges in terms of tourism destinations, on the one hand, experts mentioned the need to involve several stakeholders, especially when the moving picture media is co-financed as often the case in regard to national brands. On the other hand, the challenge of not being mistaken within the consumption of the media was stated as the following two quotes highlight:

“Let's take sun and beach destinations. You see all that, but this could be basically everywhere. In the video you get inspired, so you go to any beach. In Austria we face this challenge with ski resorts.” – (E2)

“This is especially important for destinations. For example, if you only show nature, you can confuse the recipients. Hardly anyone other than locals can differentiate mountains or lakes from others. It is therefore important to communicate the name of the destination.” – (E6)

This supports the elaboration of a unique selling proposition for the destination and engagement in the story that is guiding the moving picture. The brand itself should not be in the foreground but rather felt by the way it is presented. Though, and especially in the context of destinations, the sender must be transparent and obvious without being “*pressed in the recipient's eye*” (E5). However, the challenge of considering the diversity of a destination is constantly given which indicates the need to involve several stakeholders.

Confirming studies by Neuhofer et al. (2012), experts have argued the importance of social media and thus the need for moving pictures in the content management of social media platforms. By offering travel-related content, the pre-experience in the inspirational phase of the potential tourist can be enhanced which might result in the choice to actually visit the destination. However, it does not seem that experts generally manage the supply of immersive pre-experiences which might show that those experts are not yet fully aware of the experience propositions in the economy.

7.4 Future assessment

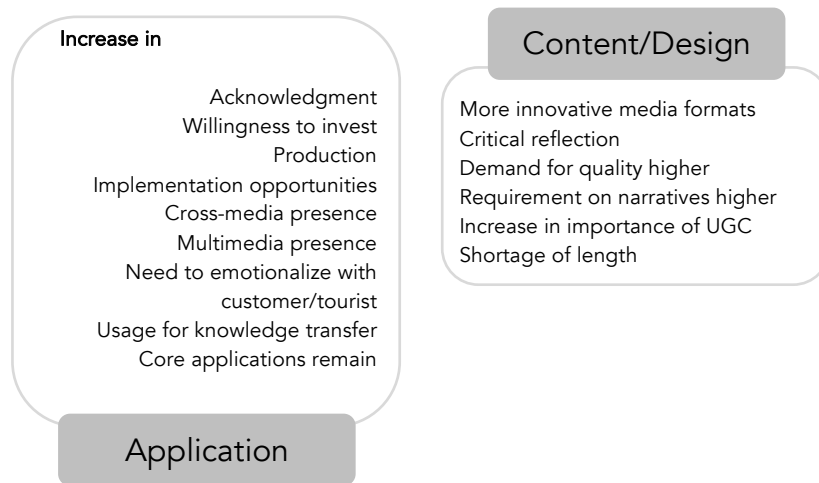


Figure 17 Future assessment; Source: Author

In order to answer the sub research question II, the experts were asked to give a personal future assessment in terms of moving pictures and its application. The answers of the conducted research are separated into two categories, which are future assessments concerning the application in brand communication in general and content and design.

“There will definitely be more and more. That doesn't necessarily mean better, but it's simpler. There are already apps that cut music to pictures.” – (E8)

Experts do believe that the usage of moving images will rise due to several reasons. An extent of acknowledgment has prospected as well as a higher willingness to invest in such media formats. Nonetheless, it is said that the available budgets for such content creations will potentially lower due to the increased need for cross-media and multimedia presence. In other words, experts believe that by being present on more platforms with various moving picture versions, the budget per media will decrease.

“The users will produce more and more the moving images themselves. However, if it falls back to the fact that it is supposed to be professional it will fall back on the professional. [...] and will become more and more, as the value of these videos will increase in the future.” – (E1)

In general, however, experts do prospect an increase in the production of moving pictures, partially caused by further technological enhancements and partially due to higher demand for such platforms based on the user's perspective. In addition, the importance of UGC and the need to get involved with such content will become an issue. Not only due to the effects on other users but also due to the power of image formation in regard to a destination. This indicates additionally that moving picture-related technologies, especially supported by artificial intelligence will continuously develop.

Higher demand is moreover assessed in terms of knowledge and information transfer as this application so far does not count as one of the main functions of moving pictures.

“Moving images play a large part in the transfer of information and in the transfer of knowledge. This issue will certainly be discussed even more in the future.” – (E4)

The research furthermore has shown that the request for experiences prior to the actual consumption/experience does exist and will eventually increase in the future. This finding indicates that some experts are already aware of virtual experiences enhancing the overall tourism experience as argued by Neuhofer et. al. (2012).

Some experts claim that image-based media will substitute text-based media even more than they are already stated to do. However, by the increased consumption of easy-to-process content, it is expected to be reflected critically as receivers do not consciously engage with media. Though, this assessment was not further discussed within this qualitative research.

It is said that the core of moving images, including the narratives based on the rules of storytelling and the aim of aroused emotions in order to emotionally tie the recipient with the brand, will remain. Solely the demand for professionally-created and high-quality media is claimed to increase which will not change the necessity of professional practitioners.

Generally, the research has resulted in experts being optimistic about the future and the remaining need of professionals in the field of moving pictures even though technologies are enhancing daily and becoming more user-friendly. Some experts fear that the demand for shorter moving pictures will rise, either caused by platform requirements in regard to length or due to changes in user behavior in terms of consumption. This, consequently, might affect their practical operations to an undefined extent.

8 Conclusion

This master thesis has provided an in-depth literature review arguing the necessity and increase of moving pictures as part of the brand communication mix. The key aspects and thus the main contribution of this thesis was to elaborate on the key characteristics of moving pictures as part of the brand communication mix, its integration in the tourism context and in addition, future assessments regarding the application of moving pictures.

By conducting qualitative and explorative research, the study has explored trends and requirements shaping the characteristics. In addition to the findings from the literature review, the research has shown that the quality of moving pictures is determined by the power of storytelling and by the fact that the brand itself is in the background, solely shaping the appearance of the moving picture based on the brand's core and its tonality. Meanwhile, the story is adapted to the interests and values of the desired target group.

Furthermore, the usage of moving pictures enables to reach more target groups at once, to explicitly narrow down which audience to target and even more, to aim target groups of all age groups due to its convenient and simple consumption. However, the study has shown that experts seem to be conscious of the need to operate recipient-oriented but do in fact act upon the customer's briefing which is to be seen critical.

This master thesis has furthermore elaborated that branded moving pictures are characterized by being an enrichment for the receiver as well as for the brand. It is defined by being easy to process, partially due to its close implementation based on realistic scenarios and based on society. Societal movements shape the moving picture in terms of the content as well as of the creation. The quality of moving images is furthermore characterized by unique design, sending a unique message. This indicates creative and unusual and therefore spectacular camera work and shots. The demand for high-quality and professionally implemented moving pictures is rising and so does the willingness to invest in multimedia content.

For tourism destination brands it is essential to acknowledge the importance of moving pictures and its power to inspire and tie potential tourists to the destination. The study has shown practitioners to not focus enough on the target audience when managing the brand's media appearance. Additionally, to apply such content into their existing brand strategy could be elaborated. Moreover, it is paramount to identify the destinations' unique selling proposition in order not to be mistaken by any other destination, independent whether it is a nation, region, city or similar.

This master thesis lastly aims to elaborate on the expert's future assessment in regard to moving pictures. It is said that the application will increase by being characterized by high-quality and the demand for strong narratives, based on the target group's preferences and user-behaviour. The usage of moving pictures for the purpose of knowledge transfer is said to rise. In addition to that, the research has shown that experts do assess an increase in

experience propositions prior to the actual (on-site) experience. Especially in the tourism context virtual experiences do count as the main source for inspiration in the pre-travel stage.

8.1 Practical implications

For brand communication practitioners as well as for the destination marketing and management organizations, various practical implications became evident. Brand marketers may aim for general marketing goals influencing the brand's success, better targeting opportunities, higher and more successful media performance and additionally aim for enhancing the tourist experience prior to the actual on-site experience. The implementation of moving pictures enables to compress messages in a single media format by reaching a broader target audience, characterized by different interests. It furthermore enhances the opportunity to reach audiences, that would not choose to consume branded content of destinations by themselves and thus increase the potential for inspiring a greater number of recipients.

It is paramount for marketers to fully engage with the brand as well as with the desired target group in order to create content according to both. An establishment of a unique selling proposition and a clear goal setting are of great importance. It is furthermore necessary to constantly apply new ICTs in order to create and design unique moving pictures that serve as enrichment for both, the target audience and the brand. By doing so, it is recommended to not put the brand itself in the foreground and to rather adapt the content to the values and interests of the target audience.

In addition, it is essential to constantly monitor current trends and developments in society and to engage with societal responsibilities amongst brand communication activities. In doing so, consistency, coherency, propriety and transparency of branded messages must be taken into consideration.

8.2 Theoretical implications

From a theoretical point of view, the contribution of this research is to generate a better understanding of the application of moving pictures within the tourism context. In specific, this research adds insights to the existing literature by identifying concepts that are relevant for visual brand communication. Therefore, this thesis contributes to prior studies by Dore & Crouch (2003), Laws et al. (2002) which investigated the lack of research regarding the practitioners' perspective. Furthermore, future assessments concerning moving pictures in terms of brand communication have been investigated which might pose to be a basis for future research.

8.3 Limitations and future research

There are several identifiable limitations of this study that simultaneously indicate possibilities for future research. First, the literature review provides only a selected examination of existing

literature regarding the topics of media history, neuromarketing insights and marketing communications. Future research, especially in terms of marketing communications, could elaborate on additional insights from other industries than tourism-related and build upon these findings.

During the interviews, it was shown that experts sometimes switch the perspective and evaluated from the recipient's point of view. This thesis, however, focused on the sender as it aims to contribute practical implications for practitioners. Nevertheless, it has shown that the potential for future research investigating the recipient's perspective on moving pictures exists.

The exploratory research aimed to interview experts from the field of brand communication including tourism-related professionals. A limitation is given by the limited sample size of eight experts. Further research could extend the sample and select experts beyond the travel and tourism industry and investigate whether there is a difference in application and key characteristics depending on the business specialization. For instance, interviewing practitioners that are specialized in product brand communication. Alternatively, researchers could use a different qualitative approach such as focus groups of experts to elaborate on the topic.

Another limitation is given by the fact that this thesis tried to elaborate on general findings regarding tourism destinations. It is critical to translate those insights into the context of single destinations as each country, region or city has its characteristics that have to be taken into account.

Lastly, this research was conducted with a qualitative approach, Thus, findings cannot be quantified and hence not be weighted regarding relevancy or importance. Studies that build on the findings could quantify the results.

VI. References

- Aberbach, J., & Rockman, B. (2002). Conducting and Coding Elite Interviews. *Political Science and Politics*, 35(4), 673–676.
- Agarwal, S., Mondal, A., & Nath, A. (2011). Social media - The new corporate playground. *International Journal of Research and Reviews in Computer Science*, 2(3), 5.
- Anholt, S. (2007). What is Competitive Identity? In S. Anholt, *Competitive Identity* (pp. 1–23). https://doi.org/10.1057/9780230627727_1
- Beißwenger, A. (2019). *YouTube und seine Kinder: Wie Onlinevideo, Web TV und Social Media die Kommunikation von Marken, Medien und Menschen revolutionieren* (2nd ed.). Baden-Baden: Nomos Verlag.
- Belting, H. (2011). *Bild-Anthropologie: Entwürfe für eine Bildwissenschaft* (4th ed.). Paderborn: Fink.
- Benckendorff, P., Sheldon, P. J., & Fesenmaier, D. R. (2014). *Tourism information technology* (2nd ed.). Wallingford, UK: CABI.
- Bhattacharjee, A. (2001). Understanding Information Systems Continuance: An Expectation-Confirmation Model. *MIS Quarterly*, 25(3), 351. <https://doi.org/10.2307/3250921>
- Blain, C., Levy, S. E., & Ritchie, J. R. B. (2005). Destination Branding: Insights and Practices from Destination Management Organizations. *Journal of Travel Research*, 43(4), 328–338.
- Bogner, A., Littig, B., & Menz, W. (Eds.). (2009). *Interviewing experts*. Basingstoke [England] ; New York: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Böhn, A., & Seidler, A. (2014). *Mediengeschichte* (2nd ed.). Tübingen: Narr Francke Attempo Verlag GmbH.
- Bordwell, D. (1985). *Narration in the fiction film*. University of Wisconsin Press.
- Bordwell, D., & Thomson, K. (2010). *Film Art: An Introduction* (9th ed.). New York: McGraw-Hill.
- Bryman, A. (2012). *Social research methods* (4th ed). Oxford ; New York: Oxford University Press.
- Buhalis, D., & Foerste, M. (2015). SoCoMo marketing for travel and tourism: Empowering co-creation of value. *Journal of Destination Marketing & Management*, 4(3), 151–161. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jdmm.2015.04.001>
- Buhalis, D., & Leung, R. (2018). Smart hospitality—Interconnectivity and interoperability towards an ecosystem. *International Journal of Hospitality Management*, 71, 41–50. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijhm.2017.11.011>

- Burmann, C., Riley, N.-M., Halaszovich, T. F., & Schade, M. (2017). *Identity-based brand management: Fundamentals - strategy - implementation - controlling*. Wiesbaden: Springer Gabler.
- Burnett, J., & Moriarty, S. E. (1998). *Introduction to marketing communication: An integrated approach*. Upper Saddle River, N.J: Prentice Hall.
- Bystrina, I. (1981). Kulturelle und filmische Codes. In *Semiotik und Massenmedien* (pp. 290–313). München: Günter Bentele Comenius.
- Cai, L. A. (2002). Cooperative branding for rural destinations. *Annals of Tourism Research*, 29(3), 720–742. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0160-7383\(01\)00080-9](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0160-7383(01)00080-9)
- Cohen, S. A., Higham, J. E. S., Gössling, S., & Peeters, P. (2014). *Understanding and governing sustainable tourism mobility: Psychological and behavioural approaches*. Retrieved from <http://public.eblib.com/choice/publicfullrecord.aspx?p=1659195>
- Craig, S. C., & Douglas, S. P. (2001). Conducting international marketing research in the twenty-first century. *International Marketing Review*, 18(1), 80–90. <https://doi.org/10.1108/02651330110398413>
- Creswell, J. W. (2014). *Research design: Qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods approaches* (4th ed.). Thousand Oaks: SAGE Publications.
- Csikszentmihalyi, M. (1977). *Beyond Boredom and Anxiety*. San Francisco, CA: Jossey-Bass.
- Cutting, J. E. (2005). *Moving Image Theory: Ecological Considerations*. Southern Illinois University Press: Anderson JD, Anderson BF.
- Daft, R. L., & Lengel, R. H. (1986). Organizational Information Requirements, Media Richness and Structural Design. *Management Science*, 32(5), 554–571. <https://doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.32.5.554>
- Damasio, A. R. (2004). *Descartes' Irrtum: Fühlen, Denken und das menschliche Gehirn*. Berlin.
- Davidson, D. (2015). *Cross-media communications: An introduction to the art of creating integrated media experiences*. Pittsburgh: ETC Press.
- Davis, F. D., Bagozzi, R. P., & Warshaw, P. R. (1992). Extrinsic and Intrinsic Motivation to Use Computers in the Workplace. *Journal of Applied Social Psychology*, 22(14), 1111–1132.
- de Buhr, T., & Tweraser, S. (2019). My Time is Prime Time. In *YouTube und seine Kinder wie Onlinevideo, Web TV und Social Media die Kommunikation von Marken, Medien und Menschen revolutionieren* (2nd ed., pp. 73–96). Baden-Baden: Nomos Verlag.

- Dinnie, K. (2007). Competitive identity: The new brand management for nations, cities and regions. *Journal of Brand Management*, 14(6), 474–475. <https://doi.org/10.1057/palgrave.bm.2550086>
- Doelker, C. (1989). *Kulturtechnik Fernsehen: Analyse eines Mediums*. Stuttgart: Klett-Cotta.
- Doelker, C. (1997). *Ein Bild ist mehr als ein Bild: Visuelle Kompetenz in der Multimedia-Gesellschaft*. Stuttgart: Klett-Cotta.
- Dore, L., & Crouch, G. I. (2003). Promoting destinations: An exploratory study of publicity programmes used by national tourism organisations. *Journal of Vacation Marketing*, 9(2), 137–151. <https://doi.org/10.1177/135676670300900203>
- Ekman, P. (1970). Universal Facial Expressions of Emotions. *California Mental Health Research Digest*, 8.
- Engell, L. (1992). *Sinn und Industrie: Einführung in die Filmgeschichte*. Frankfurt ; New York : Paris: Campus Verlag ; Edition de la Maison des Sciences de l'Homme.
- Fahlenbrach, K. (2019). *Medien, Geschichte und Wahrnehmung: Eine Einführung in die Mediengeschichte*. Wiesbaden: Springer.
- Fan, Y. (2006). Branding the nation: What is being branded? *Journal of Vacation Marketing*, 12(1), 5–14. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1356766706056633>
- Fisk, P. (2015). *Brand Innovation* (pp. 1–26). Retrieved from <http://www.thegeniusworks.com/wp-content/uploads/2015/10/Brand-Innovation-Article-by-Peter-Fisk-2015.pdf>
- Freeman, S., & Cavusgil, S. T. (2007). Toward a Typology of Commitment States among Managers of Born-Global Firms: A Study of Accelerated Internationalization. *Journal of International Marketing*, 15(4), 1–40. <https://doi.org/10.1509/jimk.15.4.1>
- Gnanapala, W. K. A. (2012). Travel Motivations and Destination Selection: A critique. *Department of Tourism Management Sabaragamuwa University Od Sri Lanka*, 2(1).
- Gnoth, J., Baloglu, S., Ekinci, Y., & Sirakaya-Turk, E. (2007). Introduction: Building Destination Brands. *Tourism Analysis*, 12(5), 339–343. <https://doi.org/10.3727/108354207783227902>
- Google. (2016). *I-Want-to-Get-Away Moments: What They Mean for Travel Marketing*. Retrieved from <https://www.thinkwithgoogle.com/marketing-resources/micro-moments/get-away-moments-travel-marketing/>
- Graap, A. (2015). *Video-Marketing: Erfolgreicher Content für YouTube & Co* (1st ed.). Frechen: mitp-Verlag.

- Gurău, C., & Ranchhod, A. (2005). International green marketing: A comparative study of British and Romanian firms. *International Marketing Review*, 22(5), 547–561.
<https://doi.org/10.1108/02651330510624381>
- Haldrup, M., & Larsen, J. (2009). *Tourism, Performance and the Everyday: Consuming the Orient* (1st ed.). <https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203873939>
- Halinen, A., & Törnroos, J.-Å. (2005). Using case methods in the study of contemporary business networks. *Journal of Business Research*, 58(9), 1285–1297.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2004.02.001>
- Halvorson, K., & Rach, M. (2012). *Content strategy for the Web* (2nd ed.). Berkeley, CA: New Riders.
- Hankinson, G. (2009). Managing destination brands: Establishing a theoretical foundation. *Journal of Marketing Management*, 25(1–2), 97–115. <https://doi.org/10.1362/026725709X410052>
- Harnad, S. (1991). Post-Gutenberg Galaxy: The Fourth Revolution in the Means of Production of Knowledge. *Public-Access Computer Systems*, 2 (1), 39–53.
- Häusel, H.-G. (Ed.). (2012). *Neuromarketing: Erkenntnisse der Hirnforschung für Markenführung, Werbung und Verkauf* (2. Aufl). Freiburg im Breisgau: Haufe.
- Hays, S., Page, S. J., & Buhalis, D. (2013). Social media as a destination marketing tool: Its use by national tourism organisations. *Current Issues in Tourism*, 16(3), 211–239.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/13683500.2012.662215>
- Herold, F., & Schulze, N. (2019). Effektive Nutzung von Bewegtbild-Werbung in der Markenkommunikation. In *YouTube und seine Kinder wie Onlinevideo, Web TV und Social Media die Kommunikation von Marken, Medien und Menschen revolutionieren* (2nd ed., pp. 135–147). Baden-Baden: Nomos Verlag.
- Huertas, A. (2015). *La comunicación de los territorios, los destinos y sus marcas. Guía práctica de aplicación desde las relaciones públicas*. <https://doi.org/10.5783/RIRP-9-2015-13-255-258>
- Huertas, A., & Marine-Roig, E. (2014). Uso y utilidades de las herramientas de análisis online para la evaluación de la comunicación de las marcas de destino a través de los social media. *Sphere Publica*, June(Special Issue), 117–134.
- Huertas, A., & Marine-Roig, E. (2015). Destination Brand Communication Through the Social Media: What Contents Trigger Most Reactions of Users? In I. Tussyadiah & A. Inversini (Eds.), *Information and Communication Technologies in Tourism 2015* (pp. 295–308).
https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-14343-9_22

- Jacobsen, J. Kr. S., & Munar, A. M. (2012). Tourist information search and destination choice in a digital age. *Tourism Management Perspectives*, 1, 39–47.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tmp.2011.12.005>
- Jansson, A. (2002). Spatial Phantasmagoria: The Mediatization of Tourism Experience. *European Journal of Communication*, 17(4), 429–443. <https://doi.org/10.1177/02673231020170040201>
- Jansson, A. (2013). Mediatization and Social Space: Reconstructing Mediatization for the Transmedia Age: A. Jansson. *Communication Theory*, 23(3), 279–296. <https://doi.org/10.1111/comt.12015>
- Jensen, K. B., & Helles, R. (2017). Speaking into the system: Social media and many-to-one communication. *European Journal of Communication*, 32(1), 16–25.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/0267323116682805>
- Jung, H., & Matt, J.-R. von. (2011). *Momentum: Die Kraft, die Kommunikation heute braucht* (6., erweiterte und aktualisierte Auflage). Berlin: Lardon.
- Keller, K. L. (2009). Building strong brands in a modern marketing communications environment. *Journal of Marketing Communications*, 15(2–3), 139–155.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/13527260902757530>
- Kotler, P., & Gertner, D. (2002). Country as brand, product, and beyond: A place marketing and brand management perspective. *Journal of Brand Management*, 9(4), 249–261.
- Kotler, Philip, & Armstrong, G. (2016). *Principles of marketing* (16th ed.). Boston, Mass.: Pearson.
- Lankow, J., Ritchie, J., & Crooks, R. (2012). *Infographics: The Power of Visual Storytelling* (1st ed.). Wiley.
- Laroche, M., Habibi, M. R., & Richard, M.-O. (2013). To be or not to be in social media: How brand loyalty is affected by social media? *International Journal of Information Management*, 33(1), 76–82. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijinfomgt.2012.07.003>
- Laws, E., Scott, N., & Parfitt, N. (2002). Synergies in destination image management: A case study and conceptualisation. *International Journal of Tourism Research*, 4(1), 39–55.
<https://doi.org/10.1002/jtr.353>
- Lee, E.-J., & Shin, S. Y. (2014). When do consumers buy online product reviews? Effects of review quality, product type, and reviewer's photo. *Computers in Human Behavior*, 31, 356–366.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2013.10.050>
- Lersch, E., & Schanze, H. (2004). *Die Idee des Radios: Von den Anfängen in Europa und den USA bis 1933*. UVK.

- Leung, D., Law, R., van Hoof, H., & Buhalis, D. (2013). Social Media in Tourism and Hospitality: A Literature Review. *Journal of Travel & Tourism Marketing*, 30(1–2), 3–22.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/10548408.2013.750919>
- Lewin, K. (1947). *Frontiers in Group Dynamics: Concept, Method and Reality in Social Science; Social Equilibria and Social Change*.
- Lindström, M. (2010). *Brand sense: Sensory secrets behind the stuff we buy* (1st ed.). New York: Free Press.
- Lindström, M., & Kotler, P. (2005). *Brand sense: Build powerful brands through touch, taste, smell, sight, and sound*. New York: Free Press.
- Lorenz-Spreen, P., Mønsted, B. M., Hövel, P., & Lehmann, S. (2019). Accelerating dynamics of collective attention. *Nature Communications*, 10(1), 1759. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-019-09311-w>
- Luhmann, N. (1996). *Die Realität der Massenmedien* (2nd ed.). Opladen: Westdeutscher Verlag.
- MacLean, P. D. (1976). Sensory and Perceptive Factors in Emotional Functions of the Triune Brain. *Biological Foundations of Psychiatry*, Raven Press, 1.
- MacLean, P. D. (1990). *The triune brain in evolution: Role in paleocerebral functions*. New York: Plenum Press.
- Marchiori, E., & Cantoni, L. (2011). The Online Reputation Construct: Does it Matter for the Tourism Domain? A Literature Review on Destinations' Online Reputation. *Information Technology & Tourism*, 13(3), 139–159. <https://doi.org/10.3727/109830512X13283928066715>
- Marlow, J., & Dabbish, L. (2014). When is a picture not worth a thousand words? The psychological effects of mediated exposure to a remote location. *Computers in Human Behavior*, 30, 824–831. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2013.08.002>
- Mayring, P. (2010). *Qualitative Inhaltsanalyse: Grundlagen und Techniken* (11., aktualisierte und überarb. Aufl). Weinheim: Beltz.
- McLuhan, M. (1962). *The Gutenberg Galaxy: The Making of Typographic Man*. Toronto: University of Toronto Press.
- Meenaghan, T. (1995). The role of advertising in brand image development. *Journal of Product & Brand Management*, 4(4), 23–34. <https://doi.org/10.1108/10610429510097672>

- Michailidis, L., Balaguer-Ballester, E., & He, X. (2018). Flow and Immersion in Video Games: The Aftermath of a Conceptual Challenge. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 9, 1682.
<https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2018.01682>
- Mickeleit, T. (2019). Corporate Video - Bewegtbilder in der Unternehmenskommunikation. In *YouTube und seine Kinder wie Onlinevideo, Web TV und Social Media die Kommunikation von Marken, Medien und Menschen revolutionieren* (2nd ed., pp. 97–108). Baden-Baden: Nomos Verlag.
- Mielau, M., & Schmiegelow, A. (2019). Markenführung in Sozialen Netzwerken - Neue Wege zum Konsumentenherz. In *YouTube und seine Kinder wie Onlinevideo, Web TV und Social Media die Kommunikation von Marken, Medien und Menschen revolutionieren* (2nd ed., pp. 109–124). Baden-Baden: Nomos Verlag.
- Mihailovich, P. (2006). Kinship branding: A concept of holism and evolution for the nation brand. *Place Branding*, 2(3), 229–247. <https://doi.org/10.1057/palgrave.pb.5990060>
- Monaco, J. (2000). *How to read a film: The world of movies, media, and multimedia: language, history, theory* (3rd ed.). New York: Oxford University Press.
- Morgan, N. J., Pritchard, A., & Piggott, R. (2003). Destination branding and the role of the stakeholders: The case of New Zealand. *Journal of Vacation Marketing*, 9(3), 285–299.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/135676670300900307>
- Mullen, L. (1998). *Truth in Photography: Perception, myth and reality in the postmodern world*. University of Florida, Florida.
- Munar, A. M. (2011). Tourist-created content: Rethinking destination branding. *International Journal of Culture, Tourism and Hospitality Research*, 5(3), 291–305.
<https://doi.org/10.1108/17506181111156989>
- Murray, H. A., & Harvard University (Eds.). (2008). *Explorations in personality* (70th ed.). Oxford ; New York: Oxford University Press.
- Neuhofer, B., & Buhalis, D. (Eds.). (2013). Experience, Co-Creation and Technology: Issues, Challenges and Trends for Technology Enhanced Tourism Experiences. In McCabe, S. (ed.) *Handbook of Tourism Marketing*. London, Routledge (pp. 124–139). London: Routledge, Taylor & Francis Group.
- Neuhofer, B., Buhalis, D., & Ladkin, A. (2012). Conceptualising technology enhanced destination experiences. *Journal of Destination Marketing & Management*, 1(1–2), 36–46.

- Olins, W. (1999). *Trading identities: Why countries and companies are taking on each others' roles*. London: Foreign Policy Centre.
- Padgett, D., & Allen, D. (1997). Communicating Experiences: A Narrative Approach to Creating Service Brand Image. *Journal of Advertising*, 26(4), 49–62.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/00913367.1997.10673535>
- Peres, M. R., Osterman, M., Romer, G. B., Stuart, N. M., & Lopez, T. J. (Eds.). (2008). *The Concise Focal Encyclopedia of Photography: from the first photo on paper to the digital revolution*. Amsterdam : [Burlington, MA]: Elsevier ; Focal Press.
- Pfadenhauer, M. (Ed.). (2009). At Eye Level: The Expert Interview – a Talk between Expert and Quasi-expert. In *Interviewing experts* (pp. 81–97). Basingstoke [England] ; New York: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Pine, B. J., & Gilmore, J. H. (1998). Welcome to the experience economy. *Harvard Business Review*, 76(4), 97–105.
- Poe, M. (2011). *A history of communications: Media and society from the evolution of speech to the Internet*. Cambridge ; New York: Cambridge University Press.
- Prahalad, C. K., & Ramaswamy, V. (2004). Co-creation experiences: The next practice in value creation. 18(3), 5–14.
- Raab, G., Unger, A., & Unger, F. (2010). *Marktpsychologie: Grundlagen und Anwendung*. Retrieved from <http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/978-3-8349-6314-7>
- Reutner, B., & Lentos Kunstmuseum Linz (Eds.). (2008). *Fotografie - die Sammlung*. Verlag Bibliothek der Provinz.
- Rockley, A., & Cooper, C. (2012). *Managing enterprise content: A unified content strategy* (2nd ed.). Berkeley, CA: New Riders.
- Roth, K. P., & Diamantopoulos, A. (2009). Advancing the country image construct. *Journal of Business Research*, 62(7), 726–740. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2008.05.014>
- Röttger, U. (1998). Kampagnen. In *Politische Kommunikation in der demokratischen Gesellschaft*. Otfried Jarren /Ulrich Sarcinelli/Ulrich Saxer: Politische Kommunikation in der demokratischen Gesellschaft. Ein Handbuch mit Lexikonteil.
- Sammer, P., & Heppel, U. (2015). *Visual Storytelling: Visuelles Erzählen in PR und Marketing*. Heidelberg: dpunkt.verlag GmbH.
- Schacter, D. L. (1997). *Searching for memory*. Basic Books; Reprint edition.

- Schulz von Thun, F. (1981). *Miteinander reden: Störungen und Klärungen: Psychologie der zwischenmenschlichen Kommunikation* (Originalausg). Reinbek bei Hamburg: Rowohlt.
- See-To, E. W. K., Papagiannidis, S., & Cho, V. (2012). User experience on mobile video appreciation: How to engross users and to enhance their enjoyment in watching mobile video clips. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 79(8), 1484–1494.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.techfore.2012.03.005>
- Shapiro, S., & Krishnan, H. S. (2001). *Memory-Based Measures for Assessing Advertising Effects: A Comparison of Explicit and Implicit Memory Effects*. 30(3), 1–13.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/00913367.2001.10673641>
- Sherwood, C. (2018). A Definition of Content Strategy. Retrieved from <https://www.firstpagedigital.sg>
website: <https://www.firstpagedigital.sg/resources/digital/a-definition-of-content-strategy/>
- Silverman, K. (2015). *The miracle of analogy, or, The history of photography*. Stanford, California: Stanford University Press.
- Skinner, H. (2005). Wish you were here? Some problems associated with integrating marketing communications when promoting place brands. *Place Branding*, 1(3), 299–315.
<https://doi.org/10.1057/palgrave.pb.5990030>
- Stankowski, A. (Ed.). (1994). *Visuelle Kommunikation: Ein Design-Handbuch* (2nd ed.). Berlin: Reimer.
- Stocchetti, M., & Kukkonen, K. (2011). *Critical media analysis: An introduction for media professionals*. Frankfurt am Main ; New York: Peter Lang.
- Sturm, H. (2000). *Der gestreßte Zuschauer. Folgerungen für eine rezipientenorientierte Dramaturgie*. Stuttgart: Klett-Cotta.
- Szondi, G. (2008). *Public diplomacy and nation branding : conceptual similarities and differences*. The Hague: Netherlands institute of international relations Clingendael.
- Tasci, A. D. A., & Kozak, M. (2006). Destination brands vs destination images: Do we know what we mean? *Journal of Vacation Marketing*, 12(4), 299–317.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/1356766706067603>
- Teng, L., Ye, N., Yu, Y., & Wu, X. (2014). Effects of culturally verbal and visual congruency/incongruency across cultures in a competitive advertising context. *Journal of Business Research*, 67(3), 288–294. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2013.05.015>

- Tropp, J. (2011). *Moderne Marketing-Kommunikation: System - Prozess - Management*. Retrieved from <http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/978-3-531-92802-9>
- Urry, J., & Larsen, J. (2011). *The Tourist Gaze 3.0*. <https://doi.org/10.4135/9781446251904>
- Van Ham, P. (2001). The Rise of the Brand State: The Postmodern Politics of Image and Reputation. *Foreign Affairs*, 80(5), 2. <https://doi.org/10.2307/20050245>
- Wit, B. de, & Meyer, R. (1998). *Strategy, process, content, context: an international perspective* (2nd ed.). London ; Boston: International Thomson Business Press.
- Wittmann, R. (1982). *Buchmarkt und Lektüre im 18. und 19. Jahrhundert: Beiträge zum literarischen Leben 1750-1880*. Retrieved from <https://books.google.at/books?id=vvEfAAAAQBAJ>
- Xiang, Z., & Gretzel, U. (2010). Role of social media in online travel information search. *Tourism Management*, 31(2), 179–188. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tourman.2009.02.016>
- YouTube. (2019). YouTube in Zahlen. Retrieved 6 September 2019, from YouTube Presse website: <https://www.youtube.com/intl/de/yt/about/press/>
- Yu, G., Carlsson, C., & Zou, D. (2014). *Exploring the Influence of User-Generated Content Factors on the Behavioral Intentions of Travel Consumers*. Presented at the Proceedings of the 25th Australasian Conference on Information Systems, 8th - 10th December, Auckland, New Zealand.
- Zimmermann, K. A. (2017). History of Computers: A Brief Timeline. Retrieved from <https://www.livescience.com/20718-computer-history.html>

VII. Appendix

Appendix 1) Semi-Structured Interview Guide for Expert Interviews

Introduction	
	<i>The author of the thesis (Viktoria Muench) thanks for the invitation and the time offered to conduct her study. She is furthermore introducing herself and the topic of the study. She makes sure that the interviewee confirms the permission to record the interview (Consent & Recording Release). She will give a short overview of what to expect during the interview. Highlights the fact, that whatever the interviewee says is correct and that the interviewed person should feel as free as possible to say whatever wants to be said.</i>
Opening	
1.	“What does your career path look like?” <i>This question is a simple question for the interviewed person and hence a great opportunity to open the interview in an easy, welcoming way to support the flow of the interview. It furthermore gives evidence of the expertise and in addition, insights for the author to ask specific questions regarding the field of expertise. It enables the author to on-side adapt the interview guide</i>
Incrementalism to the Topic	
2.	“Can you please describe me your access to conceptualize/develop/create moving-image content? “ <i>(Question is adapted depending on field of expertise)</i> <i>This question should increment into the topic and will be asked again later on to see if the interviewee might think of additional aspects during the interview.</i>
Main Part	
3.	“Why are moving-images essential in the communication mix of a brand? What are the reasons to integrate moving-images?”
4.	“As someone that is in touch with moving-images as a profession, how do you approach new projects? Which factors are essential?” <i>(Question intends to evaluate the important factors that determine moving-image content)</i>
5.	“Which goals can I achieve by implementing moving-images into my brand communication strategy?”
6.	“What are the current trends in terms of moving-image?”
7.	“What are the key characteristics of – in your opinion – good moving-images as part of the brand communication?”

8.	"I would now like to mention some keywords and would like you to ask how you would evaluate the importance and the requirements regarding the moving-image: - Length of the moving-image content - Composition of the images - Colours/Colour grading - Plot/Story ("how clear must it be? Or do I leave space for interpretation?") - Course (with opening, peak, closing) - Speed - Text in the moving-image product - In-image elements ("which kinds are there and how/why do I use them?") - Logo/Brand ("how direct is it to present? What alternatives are there to not directly but obviously communicate the brand?") - Device that recipients use to watch the moving-image content
9.	"Which requirements must moving-image content fulfil?" "Which factors determine moving-images that communicate a brand?"
10.	"Which opportunities are there to arouse emotions?" "What is it that moving-image content arouses emotions? What actions do you implement in order to arouse emotions?"
11.	"Which opportunities are there to catch the attention?"
12.	"What is it that creates relevance for the recipient?" "What are the measurement for 'relevance'?"
13.	"Let us take the case of Austria as a tourism brand, even though you might not have a tourism context: If you were about to produce/create a moving-image product for the brand: What would you say has to be included? " Which key characteristics must it fulfil?"
14.	"What are the biggest fails in terms of moving-image content?"
Ending	
	"Who are the recipients in general that you target?" What are the determinants in terms of recipients?" "How do you specify potential viewers?"
15.	„How do you assess the future of moving-image content?"
16.	"Do you have any questions to me? Is there anything you would like to add?"
Closing	
	<i>Thanking the interviewee again for taking time.</i> <i>Asking, whether it would be okay to contact for further information in case the authors needs it.</i>

Affidavit

I herewith declare on oath that I wrote the present master thesis without the help of third persons and without using any other sources and means listed herein; I further declare that I observed the guidelines for scientific work in the quotation of all unprinted sources, printed literature and phrases and concepts taken either word for word or according to meaning from the Internet and that I referenced all sources accordingly.

This paper has not been submitted as an exam paper of identical or similar form, either in Austria or abroad and corresponds to the paper graded by the assessors.

Place, date

Name and signature of student